



INSPIRE

Investing in Neighborhoods and Schools to Promote
Improvement, Revitalization, and Excellence

Arundel Elementary and Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle Schools INSPIRE PLAN



March 2017



*Arundel Elementary and
Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle Schools*
INSPIRE PLAN



Adopted by the
Baltimore City Planning Commission
March 23, 2017

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March 2017

Letter from the Director

Greetings,

It is with great pleasure that I share the Arundel Elementary and Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle Schools INSPIRE plan. I want to express sincere thanks to the many residents and community stakeholders who played a role in shaping this plan, and for their commitment to working in partnership with the City to make their neighborhood a great place to live. INSPIRE plans are created through a collaboration with many stakeholder partners including neighborhood residents, organizations, businesses, and developers; the philanthropic community; anchor institutions; City agencies; and more. Together we are maximizing the impact around the modernized schools being built around Baltimore so that when the doors open for students on their first day, there will be a noticeable difference in the neighborhood surrounding the new 21st Century facility.

Every division of the Department of Planning has been involved either in developing the INSPIRE plan or in supporting the 21st Century School process. From offering urban design, architecture, and landscape design expertise, to identifying opportunities to increase access to healthy food or to secure a site and funding resources for a community garden, my team has been committed to working with others to develop the highest-quality school facilities and INSPIRE recommendations that will strengthen the connection between each school and its surrounding neighborhood.

Our commitment doesn't end here. INSPIRE plans provide a roadmap for achieving longer-term goals around housing, environmental sustainability, safety, sanitation, transportation, and health. We will continue to work with our partners – public agencies, institutions, businesses, non-profits, philanthropy, neighborhood organizations and residents – to achieve holistic progress towards the community's aspirations. New and improved school facilities both improve quality of life for existing students and families, and serve as catalysts for attracting new residents to Baltimore neighborhoods. INSPIRE plans like this one aim to capture that potential. We welcome new ideas and partnerships to help us achieve that goal.

Sincerely,



Thomas J. Stosur
Director of Planning
City of Baltimore

Acknowledgments

The Arundel Elementary and Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School INSPIRE Plan was created by the Baltimore City Department of Planning, but is the result of a collaborative process involving significant community and City agency input. Brent Flickinger, Southern District Planner, led the creation of this plan, along with Jennifer Leonard, INSPIRE Program Manager. The Department of Planning thanks everyone who attended workshops, shared their ideas, and provided support.

Special thanks go to:

Mayor Catherine E. Pugh

Former Mayor Stephanie Rawlings-Blake

State Senator Bill Ferguson

Councilman Edward Reisinger

The many residents and stakeholders from who shared their vision and recommendations for their community, especially the member organizations of the Cherry Hill Community Coalition.

The Arundel Elementary, Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle, and Carter G. Woodson Elementary/Middle School scholars, their parents, and school leadership and faculty for their dedication to making their school and community thrive.

The Association of Baltimore Area Grantmakers and their School-Centered Neighborhood Investment Initiative, and the National Resource Network, for their involvement to help strengthen capacity, connections, and opportunities in the community.

Thank you to these City agencies who were key partners in developing this plan.

Baltimore City Department of Health

Baltimore City Department of Housing and Community Development

Baltimore City Department of Public Works

Baltimore City Department of Recreation and Parks

Baltimore City Department of Transportation

Baltimore City Public Schools System

Baltimore City Mayor's Office

Baltimore Development Corporation

Housing Authority of Baltimore City

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Overview and Introduction

21st Century School Buildings Program

21st Century School Buildings Renovation/Replacement – Phase I

INSPIRE Mission and Objectives

INSPIRE Process

21st Century School Buildings Program

In the fall of 2010, groundwork was laid to address Baltimore City's aging and inadequate public school buildings. Community, education advocacy groups, the school system, and other stakeholders built a coalition of support for legislation and funding to modernize all of Baltimore's public schools. The promise of replaced and renovated schools is meant to help transform student opportunities and achievement, provide jobs and resources to families, and help revitalize neighborhoods.

The 21st Century School Buildings Program (the Program) will support excellence in teaching and learning with flexible and adaptable space, learning areas designed for interaction and collaboration, and technology-equipped classrooms, enabling students to meet today's—and tomorrow's—high standards, and will provide communities with a shared public resource that will enrich their neighborhoods. Baltimore City will benefit for decades to come from this historic effort to provide the healthy, safe, efficient, and modern school buildings all children deserve. As a result, students in Baltimore City Public Schools will benefit from:

- Replaced or renovated school buildings across the city;
- School environments that support teaching and learning to prepare students for college and career success;
- Schools that become hubs of resources supporting entire communities;
- Modern, efficient, and inspiring educational facilities that also provide recreation and community use; and
- Partnerships that encourage businesses and neighborhood residents to connect with their local schools.

All of the major renovation and replacement projects in the Program will meet or exceed U.S. Green Building Council's LEED-Silver standard. LEED stands for Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design; LEED-certified buildings are resource-efficient and save operating costs. Each school design team works with a sustainability consultant, to ensure certification.

Financing and Administering the Program

The Baltimore City Public School System Construction and Revitalization Act of 2013 resulted in a partnership between the City of Baltimore, the State of Maryland, and Baltimore City Public Schools, financing a program that is leveraging \$60 million/year to provide approximately \$1 billion in bond proceeds for school construction issued by the Maryland Stadium Authority. Additionally, The City of Baltimore, Baltimore City Public Schools, the Interagency Committee on Public School Construction, and Maryland Stadium Authority are partnering through a Memorandum of Understanding in order to manage and oversee the plan.

School construction is typically funded by municipalities and states on a project-by-project basis. Alternative financing for school construction using this method for the Program allows Baltimore City Public Schools to expedite the process of significantly renovating or replacing 23-28 school buildings over a seven year period.

Find out more about 21st Century Schools Building Program, partnerships, school project statuses, community engagement, job/contract opportunities, and more at <http://baltimore21stcenturyschools.org>.

21st Century School Buildings Renovation/Replacement – Phase 1



INSPIRE Mission and Objectives



Each modernized 21st Century school represents tens of millions of dollars of public investment into the neighborhood it serves.

To leverage this investment, and to enhance the connection between the schools and the surrounding neighborhoods, the Department of Planning launched a new program called INSPIRE, which stands for Investing in Neighborhoods and Schools to Promote Improvement, Revitalization, and Excellence. This planning program focuses on the neighborhoods surrounding each of the schools, specifically the quarter-mile around the schools.

Focusing on a Quarter-Mile

Focusing on a limited geographic area allows plans to concentrate impact around the school so that assets and investments support the school as a community resource, build on each other, and continue to expand further into the neighborhood. Recommendations in the plan don't simply stop at a quarter-mile marker; a guiding principle however, is concentration of resources and impact. In this way, the INSPIRE plans respond to the aspirations of the neighborhood and school stakeholders in a way that is achievable.

Making an Impact

INSPIRE plans seek to lead to improvements in the



environment and in the quality of life for students, their families, and neighborhood residents and businesses. The plans will also articulate the community's long-term vision for guiding private investment, and address environmental, social, and economic conditions.

To achieve this, there are two categories of recommendations.

- To strengthen the connection between the school and community, the first set of recommendations focuses on blocks that have been designated as "primary walking routes." Standard improvements along these routes will help ensure that students and other community members have safer and more walkable access to the school. See page 27 for details.
- To address environmental, social, and economic conditions, and to help guide future investment, the second set of recommendations is divided into six goals. While all INSPIRE plans start with the same goals, community stakeholders help prioritize them; strategies and recommendations are developed in response to their input.
 - Invest in housing and market-strengthening development opportunities

- Improve safety
- Improve sanitation
- Create environmentally-sustainable neighborhoods
- Create opportunities for health and wellness
- Create connections and access

Implementing the Plans

Implementing recommendations that have been developed in partnership with community stakeholders is arguably the most important step. Throughout the planning process, the Department of Planning has met with City agencies, neighborhood stakeholders, and others who are critical partners in ensuring that recommendations become reality.

City agencies and others have committed to start making improvements by allocating staffing resources and capital dollars, and the Department of Planning is using General Obligation Bond funding (currently five million dollars for Fiscal Year 2016 and Fiscal Year 2017) to support improvements along the primary walking routes and community-selected projects. In some cases, recommendations highlight efforts already happening, or suggest programmatic partnerships. In others, stakeholders can decide to organize neighbors to implement a recommendation. Full implementation of the plans requires the engagement of the private market, anchor institutions, and the philanthropic community. The plans provide clear priorities to guide that investment.

Pages 50-55 contains implementation tables for all of the recommendations, and shows commitments that have already been made.

INSPIRE Process

The Planning Department works with community members, school stakeholders, City agencies, citywide organizations, and others to guide the INSPIRE process. Throughout the process we LISTEN, CREATE, and DELIVER.

- **LISTEN: Gathering Information**

Community stakeholders, Department of Planning staff, and other City agency staff examine existing conditions around the school and identify strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities. The Department of Planning reviews neighborhood history and plans, collects demographic data, conducts walking tours with an INSPIRE Steering Committee, convenes workshops, and conducts surveys to gather information from stakeholders.

- **CREATE: Drafting and Reviewing Recommendations**

Based on stakeholder input, Department of Planning staff drafts recommendations. Relevant City agency representatives will help identify where agencies can coordinate. Draft recommendations are shared with stakeholders, and are revised and prioritized.

- **DELIVER: Writing, Reviewing, and Executing the Plan**

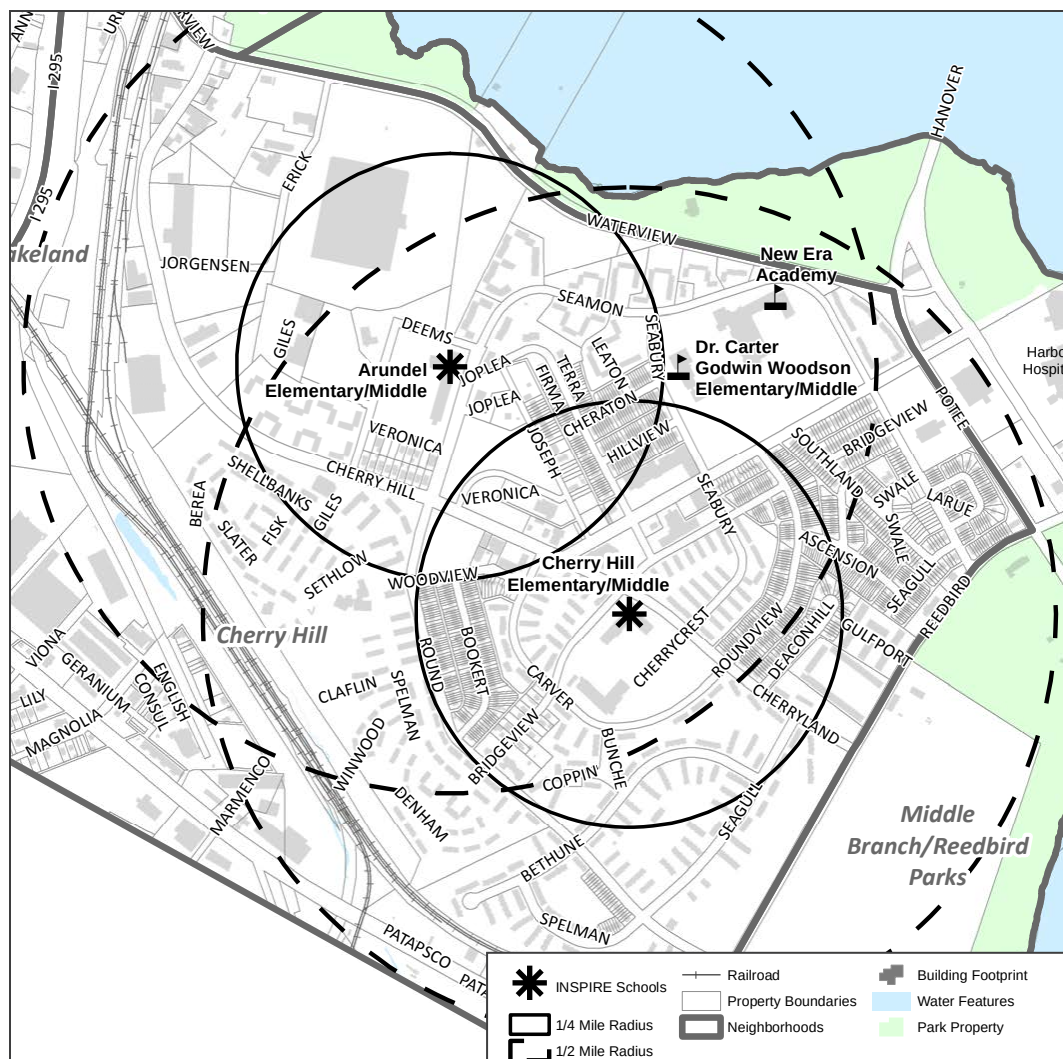
Department of Planning staff write the INSPIRE plan and share it with the community. After the plan is reviewed by the community, it is submitted to the Planning Commission for adoption.

This chart depicts the general process flow, although each planning process is unique.



INSPIRE Planning Area Background

Arundel Elementary and Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle Schools are located less than one-half mile from each other in the Cherry Hill community of South Baltimore. Cherry Hill is bordered by Hanover and Potee Streets to the east, where MedStar Harbor Hospital is located, W. Patapsco Avenue to the south adjacent to Anne Arundel County, the Middle Branch of the Patapsco River to the north, where Middle Branch Park is located near a Light Rail stop, and the neighborhoods of Westport and Lakeland to the west. Starting in the 2018-2019 school year there will be three public schools in the neighborhood: Arundel (Pre-K through 2nd grade), Cherry Hill (3rd through 8th grade), and New Era Academy (high school). Carter G. Woodson Elementary/Middle School will close at the end of the 2017-2018 school year, and students will attend one of the 21st Century schools.



Arundel and Cherry Hill School Modernizations

Three schools currently serve pre-kindergarten through 8th grade students in Cherry Hill. Of these, Arundel and Cherry Hill are being modernized, and Carter G. Woodson Elementary/Middle School will close at the end of the 2017-2018 school year. Arundel has been designated as the “early learning center” of the community and will include a Judy Center for infants through preschool, a Head Start program, and students in pre-K through second grade. The Cherry Hill building will educate children in grades 3-8.

The modernized school buildings and sites will be different from the old schools in many ways. Flexible and adaptable space, learning areas designed for interaction and collaboration, and technology-equipped classrooms will be featured. Below are other highlights.

Arundel Elementary School

- The new building, designed by GWWO and constructed by MCN Build/Southway, will replace the old 1958 building. The school building and site improvements represent a \$44 million investment in the community.
- The new building will sit at the back of the school site, and the area in the front of the building, adjacent to Round Road, will feature landscaping and outdoor learning and play spaces.
- The new building will be almost twice as large as the current building. At just over 112,000 SF, the building will accommodate up to 636 students.
- To make the school available as a resource to the surrounding neighborhood, parents, partners and community members can have access to the gym, library and cafeteria after school hours.
- Outdoor features include an amphitheater advantageously located outside of the Media Center, separate play spaces for the school, and an attached Early Childhood Development Center.
- The school will rely on street parking for student drop-off and pick-up, a drop off loop is included to minimize street congestion during these times.

Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School

- This project consists of renovation and rebuilding. The building was designed by JRS Architects and will be constructed by MCN Build/Southway. The building will retain its 1945 portion on Bridgeview, which is a designated historic landmark, and gain a new addition. The school building and site improvements represent a \$48 million investment in the community.
- The school will double in size to 128,275 SF and be large enough to accommodate 932 students with elementary and middle school students separated by floor.
- To make the school available as a resource to the surrounding neighborhood, parents, partners, and community members can have access to the gym, library, and cafeteria after school hours. There will be community space.
- The outdoor area in the rear of the school will have green space shared with the proposed regional recreation and aquatic center to be built as part of the same campus.
- The modernized building will include a secure outdoor learning area, a classroom sundial located in the rear of the building, and elementary and middle school play space with a half-size basketball court.

School Renderings



Arundel Elementary (facing Round Road)



Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle Front Elevation (facing Bridgeview Road)

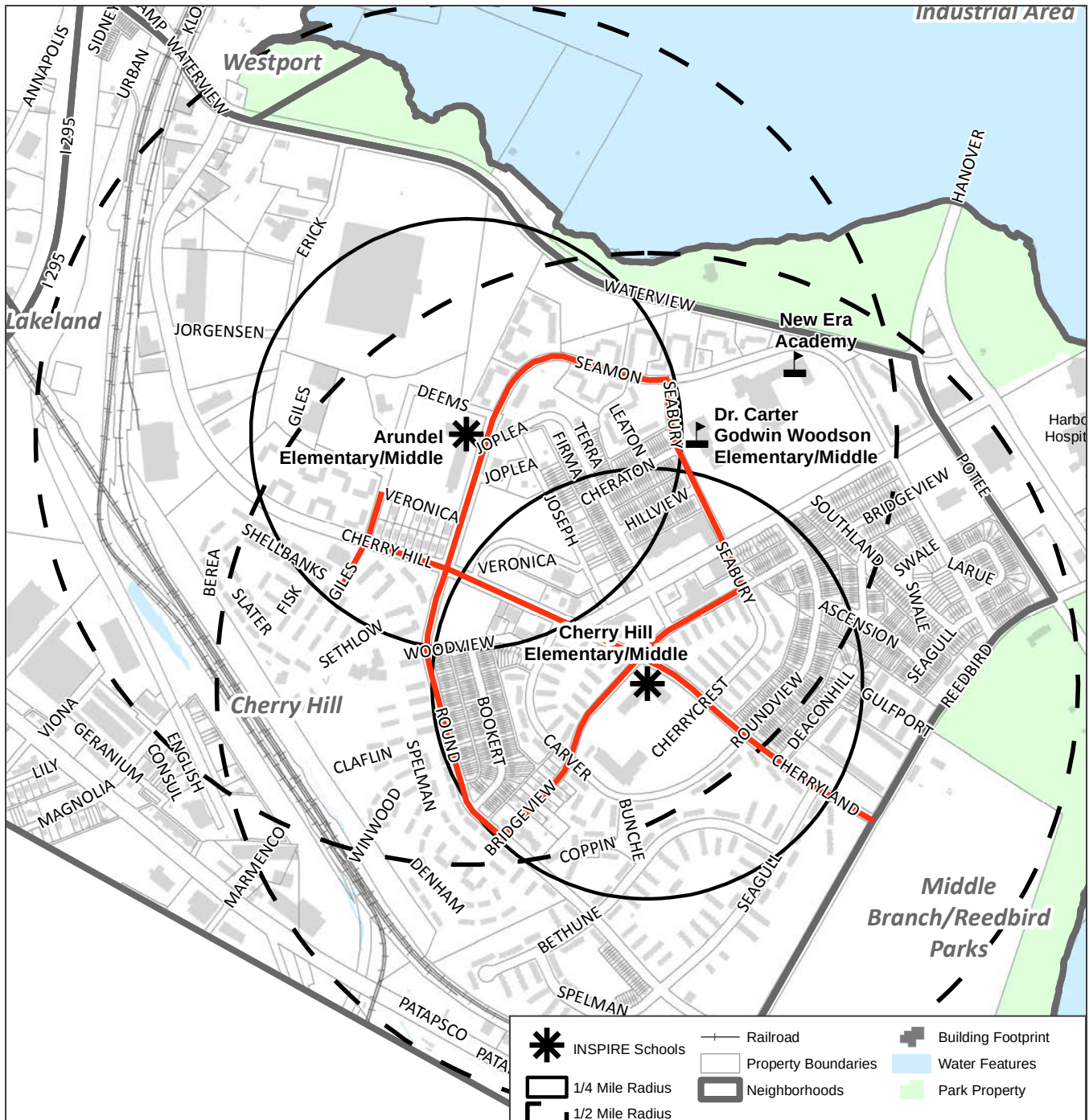


Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle
Back Play Area

Primary Routes to School

The map below identifies the perimeters around Arundel and Cherry Hill and the primary routes leading to the schools. The main walking routes used by

students to travel to and from school were identified as Cherry Hill, Round, Giles, and Cherryland Roads, and Bridgeview and Seabury Avenues.



Neighborhood History

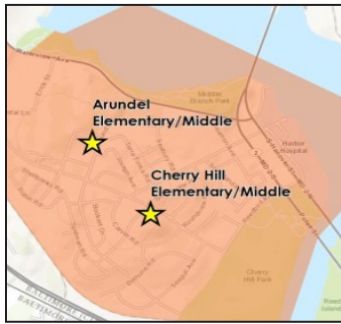
Cherry Hill's history has strongly shaped the community that exists today. The area was physically isolated from Baltimore throughout most of the 19th century. In the mid-1800s, the area was home to many amusement parks with names such as Kirby Park, Klein's Park, Meeter Park, and Starr's Park. Lincoln Park and Fish House exclusively served African Americans. All the parks offered music, eating, drinking, swimming, and fishing. Inland from the shoreline, several truck farms thrived, and several industries were located along the Curtis Bay Branch line of the B&O Railroad.

With the industrial build-up to World War II, Baltimore increasingly struggled with a housing shortage problem as thousands of African American and White southerners migrated to Baltimore, attracted by its high paying industrial jobs. Cherry Hill's close proximity to industry attracted private development in the early 1940s, with developers constructing row-house development for African Americans. In October of 1943, the Housing Authority of Baltimore City (HABC) along with the United States War Housing Administration announced they would build 600 housing units for African American War workers. In 1945, these units were occupied. Shortly after the war,

the Cherry Hill Homes were converted to low-income public housing. Cherry Hill was the first African American public housing project designed as a suburban community. By 1980, after decades of adding public housing units to Cherry Hill, it was one of the largest housing projects east of Chicago.

Cherry Hill has long been one of Baltimore's significant African American neighborhoods, contributing political leaders, writers, musicians, and others in positions of authority to the City. In the 1990s, the neighborhood went through major changes including the demolition of 1950s-era buildings and the renovations of hundreds more. Large vacant lots remain where hundreds of these units once stood. Though there have been proposals over the years for permanent or temporary uses on these former public housing lots, to date none have moved forward. On other non-HABC properties close to Hanover Street a partnership between the Landex Corporation and the Cherry Hill Community Development Corporation resulted in new construction projects known as Riverfront and Riverview. The Cherry Hill Development Corporation continues to create plans for further additional development projects in the neighborhood.

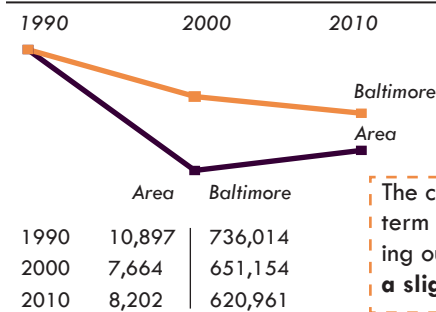
Key City and Neighborhood Data



The charts below depict data from the Census Tracts highlighted in this map (Census Tracts 2502.03 and 2502.07). Source: U.S. Census Bureau 2011-2015 American Community Survey (area data) and 1-year American Community Survey (City data).

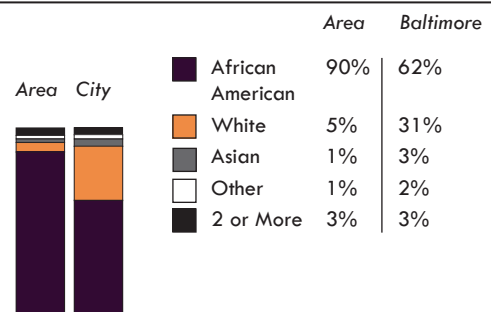
Figures may not sum to 100 percent due to rounding.

Population Change

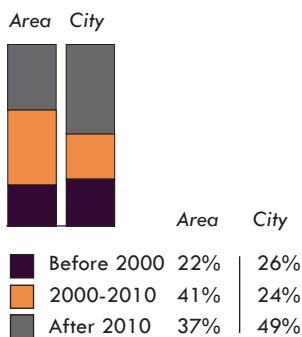


The city has sustained long-term losses that are flattening out. Cherry Hill has seen a slight increase since 2000.

Race

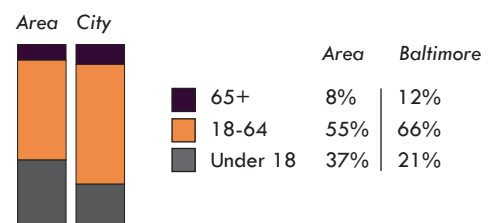


Residence Established

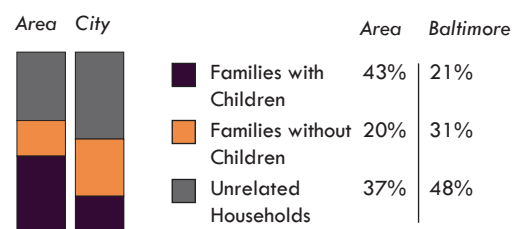


Children make up a substantially higher percentage of the Cherry Hill population than the citywide population: **37% versus 21%.**

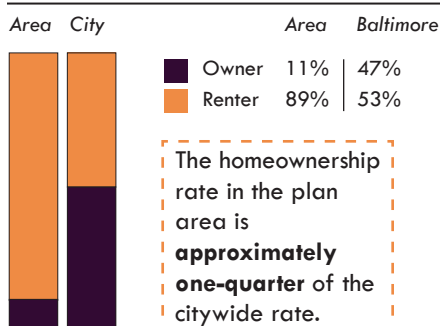
Age



Household Structure

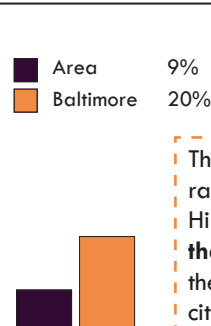


Housing Occupancy



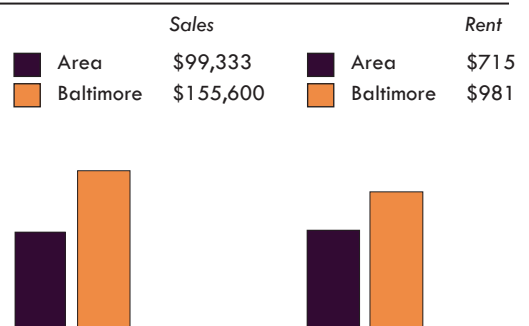
The homeownership rate in the plan area is approximately **one-quarter** of the citywide rate.

Average Vacancy Rate



The vacancy rate in Cherry Hill is **less than half** of the rate citywide.

Mean Housing Sales and Rent



Median Income

Area	\$24,952
Baltimore	\$44,165



Unemployment Rate

Area	15%
Baltimore	10%



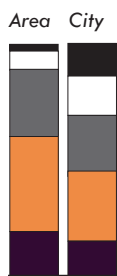
Poverty Rate

Area	38%
Baltimore	23%



Educational Attainment

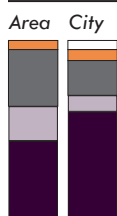
Area	City	Area	Baltimore
No HS Diploma or GED		19%	15%
HS Degree/ GED Attained		41%	30%
Some College		28%	25%
College Degree		9%	17%
Graduate Degree		2%	13%



80% of area residents have earned a high school diploma or a GED - only a **slightly lower rate** than residents citywide (85%). The rate of higher educational attainment in Cherry Hill is significantly lower.

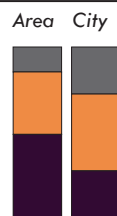
Journey to Work

Area	City	Area	Baltimore
Public Transportation		29%	20%
Carpooled		17%	9%
Drove Alone		48%	58%
Walk/Bike		5%	8%
Other/Work at Home		1%	6%



Vehicle Availability

Area	City	Area	Baltimore
No Vehicles		51%	31%
1 Vehicle		34%	39%
2+ Vehicles		15%	30%



The percentage of households in Cherry Hill without access to a car is **approximately two-thirds of the rate citywide**. Twice as many households in the area carpool, and 64% more households (about a third of the households) use public transportation.

Percentage of Population Living in a Food Desert

Area	90%
Baltimore	25%



Cherry Hill has one of the highest rates of people living in a food desert in the city. Food access is a significant challenge for residents of all ages.

Neighborhood Observations

The INSPIRE plan area is located in Cherry Hill, a geographically self-contained peninsula in South Baltimore. The neighborhood is partially surrounded by the Patapsco River and railroad tracks. The neighborhood consists of several discrete “zones”:

- A residential area with a small commercial district (the Cherry Hill Town Center) north of Cherry Hill Road
- A residential area south of Cherry Hill Road
- Reedbird Park and Reedbird Avenue on the southern edge of the neighborhood
- Middle Branch Park and the properties along Waterview Avenue across from the Light Rail station

The layout of the community is such that one can easily walk between the schools and through the town center area.

Civic Engagement

Cherry Hill has a number of active organizations that are developing many neighborhood strategies and are responsible for helping move forward existing plans. They also participate in the South Baltimore Gateway Partnership (SBGP, an alliance of representatives of the dozen neighborhoods surrounding the Horseshoe casino), SB7 (a partnership between Sagamore Development and seven neighborhood groups adjacent to the planned Port Covington community).

The organizations mentioned in this plan are:

- Cherry Hill Community Coalition: an umbrella group charged with implementing the master plan; CHCC brings many stakeholders such as neighborhood associations, churches, service organizations, and businesses

together monthly to discuss issues of concern. CHCC has committees and members, including:

- Cherry Hill Education Team: a committee of the CHCC
- Cherry Hill Trust: a nonprofit-member focused on public safety and education
- Cherry Hill Community Development Corporation: CHDC
- Cherry Hill Homes and Cherry Hill Tenant Council: a public housing project and public housing residents

Land Use and Housing

Cherry Hill is characterized by low-rise housing, hills, green space, and a meandering street pattern that give it a small-town feel. The Town Center in the heart of the residential neighborhood offers retail amenities and services, including a branch of the Enoch Pratt Library. The part of the neighborhood along Waterview Avenue near the Light Rail station sits 100 feet below the residential area around the Town Center, and has been an underused industrial area. This area has been rezoned for Transit-Oriented Development (TOD).

The housing is generally two- and three- stories high. Residential vacancy is fairly low – less than one-half of the city’s average. While there are stable blocks made up almost entirely of homeowners, there are also over 800 private, subsidized apartment units and over 1,100 public housing rental units. Newer homeowner units and larger rental units, known as Riverfront and Riverview, have been built in recent years near Pottee Street. A senior housing building sits near the Town Center, Arundel Elementary, and the Urban Garden site.

Demolition of a large number of public housing units over the years has created several large tracts of vacant land owned by the Housing Authority of Baltimore City (HABC).

- One portion of a four-acre site closest to the heart of Cherry Hill and across the street from Arundel Elementary School and the Cherry Hill Manor Senior Center, known as Fisher's Cove, is being used for an urban garden and farm stand. The Cherry Hill Development Corporation (CHDC), whose partners include the Cherry Hill Tenants Council, envisions mixed-income housing on the site in the future.
- A lot, located on Round Road across from the planned new regional recreation center and Cherry Hill Elementary-Middle School, is also being considered for new housing.
- Two sites along Reedbird Avenue right off of Potee and Hanover Streets (across from a former landfill and incinerator) may be appropriate for mixed-use development.

Development Opportunities

As noted above, there are multiple HABC sites suitable for future development in the area. In addition, there are other immediate opportunities that will impact the neighborhood.

- A vacant parcel of land across from Arundel Elementary is in the early phase of pre-development for new homes
- Scattered site vacant housing presents an opportunity for more homeownership.
- Sagamore Development, the developers of the future Port Covington community, directly across the river, is committed to providing 20% of its affordable housing unit requirement off site. This commitment may provide opportunities for new housing that is appropriately priced for the needs of Cherry Hill. The newly forming SB7 multi-neighborhood coal-

tion is partnering with Sagamore, and discussions are taking place about the possibility of new housing in Cherry Hill, Westport, and other nearby neighborhoods.

- The new TOD zoning near the Light Rail station can accommodate mixed-use development.

Sustainability and Infrastructure

Flooding has been a major issue for years along Spelman Avenue and Round Road, and the roadbed along this stretch of Spelman has deteriorated. Some public housing units at the foot of Round Road and Spelman Avenue, adjacent to the CSX railroad tracks flood because of their position at the bottom of a hill and poor drainage. An upgrade to a major storm water pipe that empties along Patapsco Avenue, planned for fiscal year 2018, will relieve much of the flooding. In addition, Blue Water Baltimore's Deep Blue program is focused on additional storm water mitigation and tree plantings.

Public Safety and Sanitation

Crime is a concern for residents. Multiple efforts are underway to improve safety in the area, including through the public safety committee of the Cherry Hill Community Coalition (CHCC) and the presence of the Guardian Angels at the Cherrydale Apartments. A number of gang members recently were indicted or sent to prison, and shootings are now rare. A violence prevention program called Safe Streets operates in the neighborhood and has also made a big contribution to the decrease in violent crime in the last two years, though its budget has been cut recently.

"Crime and grime" are often linked in affecting the quality of life in a community. Generally the Cherry Hill neighborhood is free of trash but there are a few places where dumping takes place, and some alleys where residents throw trash. The active neighborhood associations regularly address these issues and sanitation was not mentioned as a major concern in commu-

nity meetings.

Recreation and Open Space

Cherry Hill is well-served by both indoor and outdoor recreation spaces, although improvements could be made to make them more accessible.

- The new recreation center – to start construction in the next few years – will be a regional aquatic center adjacent to Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School in the heart of the neighborhood, and just one mile from the Light Rail station.
- Middle Branch Park is a significant amenity on the edge of Cherry Hill that provides access to water-based recreation on the Middle Branch of the Patapsco River. There is a considerable grade difference between the heart of the neighborhood and Cherry Hill Road leading to the park. As a result, the park is underused by neighborhood and Baltimore residents. Providing easier access to the park from the residential portion of the neighborhood is a priority for community leaders.
- The Baltimore Rowing Club serves residents and school programs throughout the region. Residents can kayak from Middle Branch Park to other locations in the Patapsco and the Inner Harbor. The Rowing Club is also pursuing designation of a water trail along the Middle Branch adjacent to Cherry Hill as a trail to celebrate the voyage of John Smith.
- The Gwynns Falls Trail goes through Cherry Hill, although sections are not well-maintained.
- Cherry Hill Park, referred to locally as Reed-bird Park, is home to an outdoor pool and basketball courts. This former landfill site could be further developed for recreational activities.
- Cherry Hill Homes, a public housing complex, has a number of play areas, many of which need to be upgraded. HABC is working with the tenant council to improve several

of them.

Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School students are attending classes next door at Patapsco while Cherry Hill is under construction. During this time, the existing rec center at Patapsco is closed. The CHCC is working with the Department of Recreation and Parks (BCRP) to explore interim recreational facilities and programs.

Transportation

There are convenient ways to drive in/out and around the neighborhood, but it is important to keep in mind that many residents do not have access to a vehicle.

- Major roads connecting South Baltimore with downtown (Waterview Avenue, Patapsco Avenue, Hanover Street, and Potee Street) and major highways run along the edges of the neighborhood (Interstate 95 and MD 295). Hanover Street intersects with I-895 in nearby Brooklyn and becomes Ritchie Highway to the south in Anne Arundel County where major shopping areas exist. Cherry Hill Road bisects the neighborhood, and connects Arundel and Cherry Hill schools. In addition to serving local traffic, it is also a through-street from Potee and Hanover to Waterview Avenue and MD 295. This often results in unsafe, high-speed traffic which must be addressed.
- The Cherry Hill Light Rail station provides access to downtown. However, its location at the bottom of the hill near Middle Branch Park, however, is inconvenient for many residents living a considerable distance away. Some of these individuals find it more convenient to make a dangerous crossing over the CSX railroad tracks near Spelman Avenue and Round Road to access the Patapsco Light Rail stop in Baltimore County or shops on Patapsco Avenue.
- Through Sagamore Development, water taxi stops are being planned, and at least one might be along the waterfront in Cherry Hill.

Unsafe conditions, noted above, are compounded by students and other residents not using designated intersections to cross Cherry Hill Road. Once the 21st century school buildings reopen, families may have children in two or three different schools in the neighborhood, and providing safe crossings across Cherry Hill Road will become even more of a priority than it is now.

Education Strategy

The CHCC and Cherry Hill Education Team have a strategy to develop a lifelong learning school continuum within the neighborhood. The 21st Century Schools projects fit into that strategy, beginning with an early childhood learning center at Arundel. In addition to the Arundel and Cherry Hill modernization, other current and future educational facilities complete the continuum. New Era High School

absorbed a program in 2015 called the Maritime Trades Academy, which prepares students for port-related careers and has now become a comprehensive transportation technology program. The Education Team is in conversations with the Port Alliance (an alliance of major businesses at the Port), BCPSS, and Baltimore City Community College about career-path training for jobs in the transportation sector. These entities have formed a partnership, informally known as the MOA Partnership (Memorandum of Agreement) to accomplish this. This jobs sector may be a popular career choice for existing or new Cherry Hill residents due to the neighborhood's proximity to the Port, the airport, and major highways. Though this program would attract students from other neighborhoods, it would be possible for children in Cherry Hill to begin school as infants and take courses up to the community college level all within walking distance from home. Adult education would also be part of the

Existing Plans and Initiatives

A number of plans have been produced in the Cherry Hill neighborhood. The INSPIRE plan has been informed by each of them.

Existing Plans

Cherry Hill 2000

As a blueprint for the neighborhood entering the 21st Century, an organization called Cherry Hill 2000 worked with local stakeholders to create the outline of a plan called Cherry Hill 2000. Cherry Hill Trust spearheaded a follow-up effort in the mid-2000s. Many of the recommendations from these planning efforts were incorporated into and expanded upon in the Cherry Hill Community Master Plan.

Middle Branch Master Plan (2007) and Cherry Hill Community Master Plan (2008)

The Middle Branch plan focused on environmental issues and ways to highlight the character of the Middle Branch of the Patapsco River. It included a section on Sustainable Communities, and many of the ideas were then proposed in the Cherry Hill Community Master Plan, under development at the same time. The Master Plan, the first comprehensive plan for the neighborhood, offered recommendations for physical development, economic development, historic preservation, transportation, public safety, health, education, youth, and civic engagement. The Cherry Hill Community Master Plan makes some recommendations about land use, but this chapter was not fully developed. As a result of the Master Plan, an umbrella neighborhood group, the Cherry Hill Community Coalition (CHCC), was formed and charged with its implementation.

South Baltimore Gateway Master Plan (2015)

The SBG Master Plan provides specific recommen-

dations for about a dozen neighborhoods, including Cherry Hill. This plan includes many of the ideas from both the Cherry Hill Community Master Plan and the NCD study, which began before the SBG Master Plan. It also provides site-specific recommendations for the neighborhood. Many of the recommendations in the SBG Master Plan apply to a number of neighborhoods. One example is the desire for shuttle service of some kind connecting these neighborhoods that are somewhat geographically cut off from one another by highways, railroad right-of-ways, and waterways.

Neighborhood Design Center Land Use Vision Plan (2016)

The Cherry Hill Development Corporation contracted NDC to complete a land use vision plan for the neighborhood, which was completed in 2016. The purpose was to create a community investment strategy to guide public and private investment in the neighborhood.

Evolving Plans and Strategies

The Cherry Hill neighborhood falls within the boundaries of the casino impact area. According to State law, 5.5% of slots revenue from Maryland casinos is to be spent in the neighborhoods determined to be impacted by the casino. This money, known as Local Impact Grant funds, is estimated to be at least \$14 million a year. Responsibility for allocation of these funds is split evenly between funds that the Local Development Council (LDC) recommends that City government agencies spend in the neighborhoods surrounding the Horseshoe casino and funds spent by the community-led South Baltimore Gateway Partnership (SBGP). The Cherry Hill Community Coalition has a seat on the board of the SBGP. Projects to be funded come from the recommendations in the South Bal-

timore Gateway Master Plan and previous spending priorities of the LDC. Cherry Hill is also one of the SB7 neighborhoods creating a nonprofit partnership with Sagamore Development, the master developer of

Port Covington. As SB7 takes shape, the SB7 partner neighborhoods, which includes Cherry Hill, will have at least another \$1 million per year to spend on initiatives to be determined by its board.

INSPIRE Recommendations

Plan Development and Overview

Standard Improvements – Primary Walking Routes

Goals, Strategies, and Recommendations – Arundel Elementary and Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle Schools Planning Area

Plan Development and Overview

Between February and August 2016, Department of Planning (DOP) staff worked with members of the school and neighborhood communities to better understand their neighborhood experiences, concerns, and needs. Through community workshops, community meetings, and surveys, stakeholders have helped inform the draft recommendations presented here. Recommendations from previous plans were also evaluated and included where appropriate.

- DOP held INSPIRE workshops in March (to identify strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities), June (to discuss priorities and recommendations), and October (scenario planning and further prioritization). In addition to neighborhood residents, workshop participants included representatives from Harbor Hospital, Catholic Charities (which owns the Town Center shopping center), staff from the Association of Baltimore Area Grantmakers, and Blue Water Baltimore, which is working on tree planting and other environmental initiatives in Cherry Hill.
- The National Resource Network (NRN) worked with DOP to create different “future scenarios” of the neighborhood (Cherry Hill ten years from now) for the third INSPIRE workshop. This resulted in recommendations anchored in the future that stakeholders would like to see. The NRN also helped frame potential opportunities to work with anchor institutions in Cherry Hill.
- Several residents volunteered to participate in an INSPIRE Steering Committee to help advise the process.
- DOP administered a survey to parents, family members, and residents through meetings and online. The survey was also distributed by

Steering Committee members and through Cherry Hill Community Coalition meetings.

- A Steering Committee of parents, residents, and other stakeholders is serving as a small advisory group.
- DOP worked with the community school coordinators to hold three sessions with middle school students that included identifying area strengths and opportunities, and conducting field research.
- Through the Association of Baltimore-Area Grantmakers’ School-Centered Neighborhood Investment Initiative, the philanthropic community is developing a strategy to attract private investment, increase capacity of community-based organizations, and leverage physical development to support transformational neighborhood revitalization. This helped inform recommendations in this plan.
- In January, DOP conducted a “virtual voting” campaign to solicit interest in one of seven possible community-prioritized projects. Fliers were handed out at schools, housing developments, the Town Center, and at community meetings; large posters were placed in a few prominent locations in the neighborhood. Residents voted for their top project through text, email, phone, or in-person. Almost 200 responses were received.

Staff from City agencies, including Housing and Community Development, the Department of Transportation, Department of Recreation and Parks, the Department of Public Works, and the Department of Health also participated in meetings and/or worked with DOP staff to address stakeholder priorities.

Standard Improvements – Primary Walking Routes



Ensuring that students and other community members have safe and attractive pedestrian access to the school is critical to strengthening the connection between the school and community. Therefore, one part of each INSPIRE plan is a focus on the blocks that have been designated as the “primary walking routes.” See page 16 for the primary routes map.

The Department of Planning used BCPS student/school zone data, and worked with community members, school staff, and crossing guards, and the Department of Transportation, to identify the predominant routes that students use to get to and from the

school. Within the ¼-mile INSPIRE planning area, blocks on these routes have been designated as the primary walking routes. These blocks are being prioritized for consistent streetscape improvements that will occur prior to the school reopening. They have also been designated as Safe Routes to School routes, and will be marked with the City’s Safe Routes to School wayfinding footprints.

Through commitments from many City agencies, these key improvements will be made along the primary walking routes:

- Bringing sidewalks up to a safe and standard condition
- Repainting or adding crosswalks
- Assessing the need for repairs to ADA ramps at intersections
- Marking Safe Routes to School footprints
- Assessing crossing guard deployment
- Pruning and planting street trees
- Assessing street lighting
- Boarding open vacant buildings
- Picking up trash and maintaining vacant lots

The Implementation Table on page 50 provides additional details.

Goals, Strategies, and Recommendations – Arundel Elementary and Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle Schools Planning Area

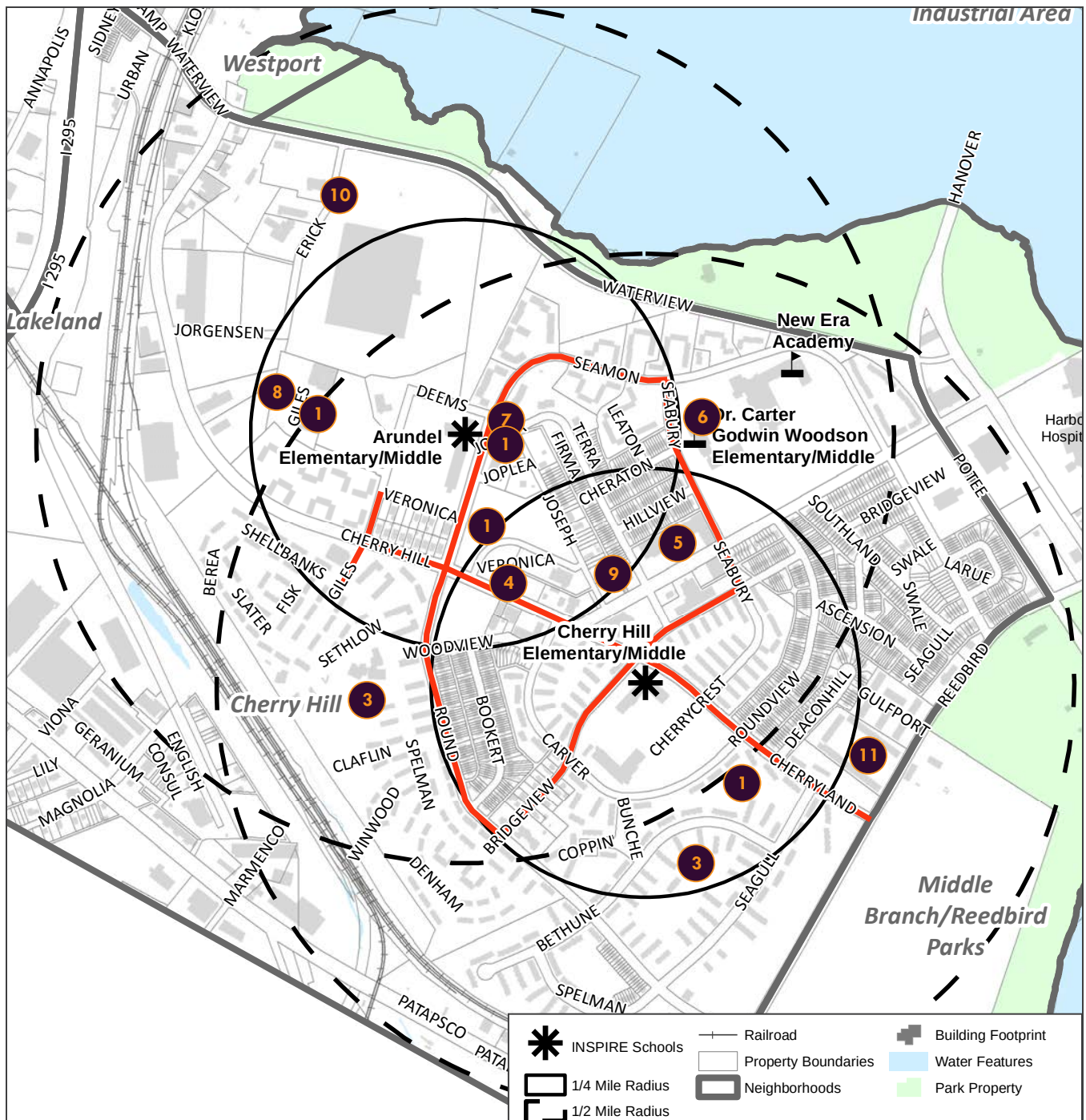
The recommendations presented in the remainder of this report are in addition to those that address the issues along the primary walking routes, listed on page 27. Recommendations presented in this section have been informed by community workshops, surveys, and walking tours. Many recommendations described could easily fit under more than one goal.

Recommendations for the Arundel Elementary and Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle Schools Planning Area fall under these goals and strategies:

- Invest in Housing and Market- Strengthening Development Opportunities
 - Increase Quality Housing Options
 - Promote Strategic Redevelopment Opportunities
- Improve Safety
 - Promote Safety at Key Locations
- Create Connections and Access
 - Improve Walking Access and Safety in the Neighborhood
 - Improve Street Infrastructure
 - Increase and Improve Public Transportation
- Create Opportunities for Health and Wellness
 - Enhance the Healthy Food Environment
 - Improve Recreational Opportunities
 - Improve Community Cohesion
- Create an Environmentally-Sustainable and Clean Neighborhood
 - Create a Clean and Green Neighborhood
 - Address Trash and Dumping Problems
- Provide Opportunities for Economic Self-Sufficiency
 - Provide training and access to jobs
- Strengthen Partnerships and Social Connections
 - Strengthen the Connection between Residents, the Retail and Community Facilities, and Community-based Organizations
 - Expand Recreational Programming
 - Address Education/School/Family/ Student Needs
 - Market Cherry Hill

INVEST IN HOUSING AND MARKET-STRENGTHENING DEVELOPMENT OPPORTUNITIES

Diversify housing inventory and re-establish a retail presence.



Increase Quality Housing Options



1. Develop a range of mixed-income housing for rent and for ownership.

Currently, housing in Cherry Hill offers few opportunities for market-rate rental or homeownership. While a large number of publicly-subsidized and private affordable rental units meet the housing need for households earning low incomes, there is limited inventory for households earning moderate incomes. Rehabilitation of vacant properties scattered throughout the neighborhood and redevelopment of large vacant land parcels can provide these units. In order to create a mixed-income community, that offers a range of housing but also preserves the affordable units, community leaders, working with HCD, should consider multiple housing types and ownership structures. One important step could be for an entity (an existing CDC or new organization) to acquire long-vacant houses to be included in a community land trust or to be part a community-driven strategy to acquire properties and sell them to homeowners. A land trust is usually managed by a community organization and provides covenants to ensure that the buildings remain affordable. HCD's Code Enforcement division could assist in moving appropriate properties into receivership so that the designated CDC can acquire them at auction. In addition, tracts of land in the industrial

area and along the waterfront have been rezoned for mixed-use development, which could include housing. A few larger sites in the residential area can accommodate new infill housing:

- 2800- and 2900-blocks of Joseph Avenue and Joplea Road
- 2490 Giles Road
- 820 Cherry Hill Road (Fisher's Cove)
- 800-block of Roundview Road

2. Promote homeownership assistance programs to help current and new owners maintain and improve their homes.

Many of the residential blocks near the schools have a significant number of homeowners. Maintaining these blocks, and keeping the homeowners, is critical to building confidence and stability in the neighborhood. Programs run by the City and non-profits can help these homeowners. Programs run by the City and non-profits that can help these homeowners maintain their properties should be promoted within the plan area to connect people with available resources to maintain their homes. The CHDC, schools, churches, and other entities can do this at meetings and events.

- Connect homeowners with programs available through Baltimore Housing's Green, Healthy and Sustainable Homes division by sharing program information at community association meetings, community events, and through the school.



- Promote the Baltimore Energy Challenge to educate homeowners about lowering energy bills by sharing program information at community meetings, school events, and other gatherings.

3. Improve the quality of public housing and the living situation for public housing residents.

The quality and design of the public housing in Cherry Hill has a significant impact on public housing residents and others in the neighborhood. Redevelopment of Cherry Hill is a long term project. In the interim HABC will continue to maintain the housing within the constraints of funds provided by Congress.

Promote Strategic Redevelopment Opportunities



4. Determine potential short-term uses of Fisher's Cove site.

This HABC site at the corner of Round and Cherry Hill Roads (820 Cherry Hill Road) covers more than four acres of mostly vacant land. Although this site, across the street from Arundel Elementary, offers many possibilities for redevelopment, a recent study indicated that large subsidies would be required in order to support developing mixed-income housing. The Cherry Hill Development Corporation, in consultation with City agencies, is exploring options for long-term

reuse of the site. In the short term, the site can house a range of temporary uses. Currently, the Cherry Hill Urban Garden, which has a lease from HABC to grow vegetables for several years for sale to Cherry Hill residents and through the Farm Alliance, operates on a portion of this property as an interim use until new investment takes place. The garden could be enhanced with a market stand, and other temporary uses, such as a location for pop-up businesses, should be explored. CHDC should set a deadline to present a recommendation to HABC for short-term and temporary use.

5. Make improvements to the exterior façade and design of the Town Center.

The centrally-located Town Center is a small shopping center with convenience stores, food and personal service vendors, offices, and community services such as a branch of the Enoch Pratt Library. It is a gathering place for residents. Catholic Charities made a significant investment to the site when they acquired it in 1997, but twenty years later it needs upgrades. The owners are discussing ways to improve the Town Center with the Baltimore Development Corporation.



6. Continue to explore reuse of the Carter G. Woodson school building.

The Carter G. Woodson Elementary-Middle School is currently slated to close, after which the site will undergo a process to “surplus” the building so that it can be reused in a productive way. Initial conversations among the Port Alliance, City Schools, and Baltimore City Community College have included a

recommendation to offer adult education programs, although further community input is needed. The City will conduct community stakeholder engagement and analysis, including explaining the surplus school disposition process, sharing profiles of potential re-uses, engaging stakeholders about desired uses, explain market assessment, and engage stakeholders about concerns for the site. Discussions about desired uses could include short-term and long-term uses, indoor and outdoor uses, shared use opportunities, demolition and open space opportunities, as well as demolition and new construction opportunities.

7. Ensure that the owner of the property at 2800 Joplea Avenue keeps it well-maintained prior to its development.

2800 Joplea Avenue is located across the street from Arundel Elementary and its maintenance and redevelopment will have a significant impact on the school. The owner of the site is developing a proposal to build homeownership housing units on the site. Prior to development, the site should be cleaned-up and well maintained, so that it is an attractive site for children attending the school.

8. Reuse 2490 Giles Road to meet community-identified needs.

Currently, a methadone clinic is located on Giles Road, behind Arundel Elementary school. The clinic is relocating, and this City-owned property is being evaluated for short-and long-term uses. One priority is to ensure that the building is in continuous use, possibly with City programs and offices. The Cherry Hill leadership is working closely with the City government on this project.

9. Explore opportunities to temporarily reuse and redevelop the former BGE site and other properties near the Town Center for new businesses.

The Town Center on Cherry Hill Road serves as the primary retail and service area in the community. It is also a central gathering place. While this site may not



be able to accommodate all of the residents' desires – such as a bank, clothing store, movie theater, post office, and restaurants – residents are interested in seeing the Town Center area grow into a true community hub. In the medium- or long-term, the properties in the 700-block of Cherry Hill Road from Terra Firma to the site of the former BGE substation on the north-west corner of Cherry Hill Road and Joseph Avenue adjacent to the Town Center could be redeveloped for pop-up and permanent businesses. In the short-term, the highly-visible BGE site could be temporarily landscaped, or otherwise decorated to be more attractive to children and others as they pass by on their way to school. Community stakeholders should work with BGE.

10. Make efforts to attract transit-oriented development opportunities adjacent to the Light Rail station on Cherry Hill Road.

As highlighted in the South Baltimore Gateway Master Plan and Transform Baltimore, vacant or underutilized properties in close proximity to the Light Rail station should be prioritized for mixed-use transit-oriented development. The new Transit Oriented Development zoning for this area will allow major projects to be built on these underutilized parcels and could draw a critical mass of people from the larger geographic area needed to support a supermarket or pharmacy, as well as other goods and services.



11. Determine temporary uses for vacant HABC properties along 800- and 900-blocks of Reedbird Avenue (C.K. Anderson site).

With easy access to Potee and Hanover Streets and Harbor Hospital, this HABC site is a good location

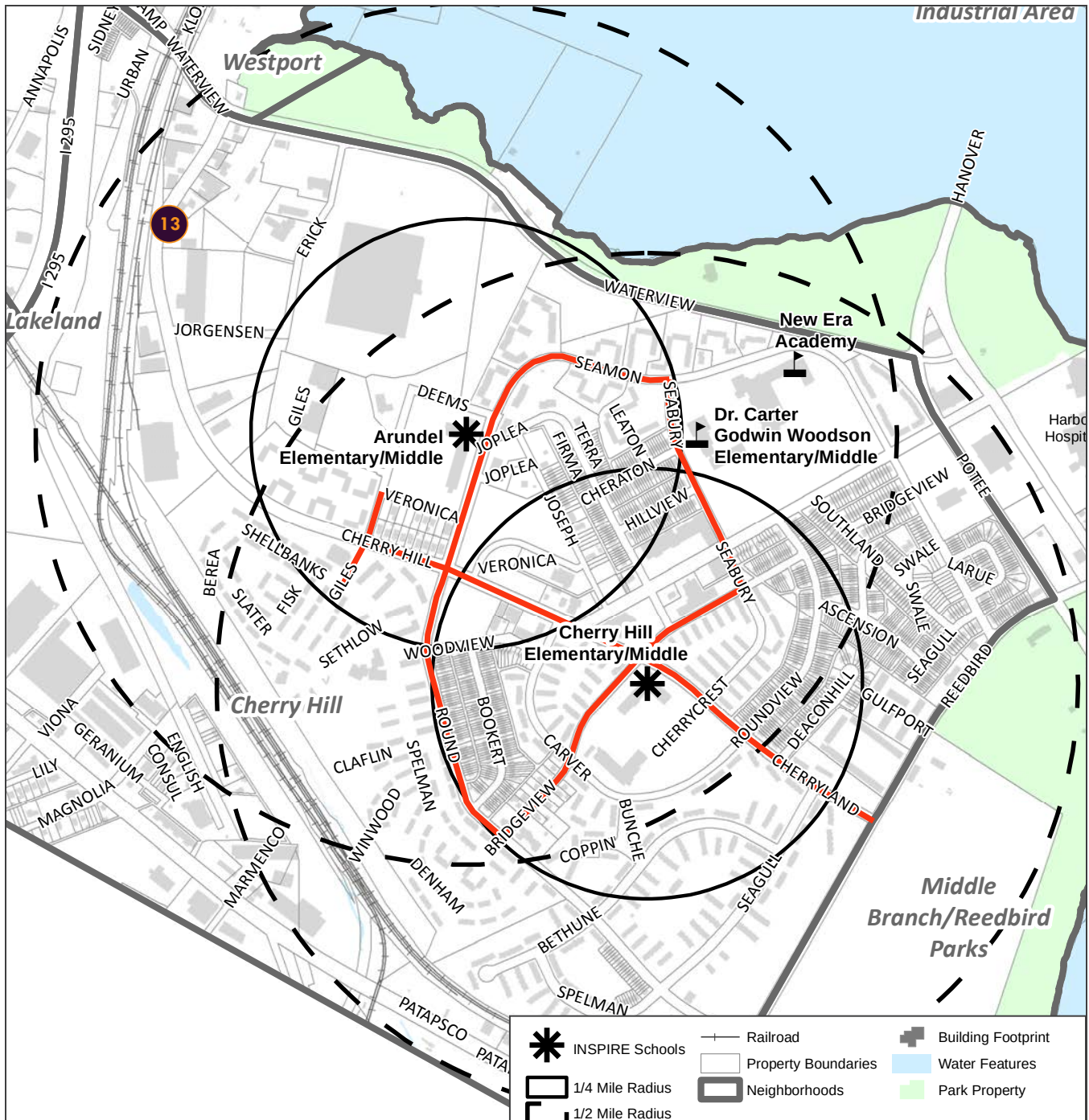
for offices or businesses. In the shorter-term, the site should be activated through a temporary use. One proposal made recently is for a tree farm. The next step for using the site, which may be contaminated due to its location across from a former incinerator and landfill, would be to conduct a Phase 1 environmental study to determine if contamination is present.

12. Create opportunities for business incubation.

Incubator spaces of all kinds are popping up throughout Baltimore, from City Garage to Open Works and the Food Hub. Incubator spaces in Cherry Hill would be intended to target people living in Cherry Hill who have business ideas but need a place to test them out. BDC is exploring options with the CHDC.

IMPROVE SAFETY

Create a positive and safe environment for current and future residents.



Promote Safety at Key Locations

13. Improve lighting and security around the Light Rail tunnel and deter drug activity.

Many residents discussed feeling unsafe around the Light Rail tunnel on Cherry Hill Road. The City's Department of Transportation (DOT) is developing designs to upgrade the area adjacent to the station and make it safer and more accessible, primarily by improving Americans with Disabilities (ADA) access. Improvements will be made with \$1 million in federal funds that DOT has received.

14. Southern Police District police and the community should expand partnerships to prevent and reduce crime, especially among juveniles.

Recent successes, such as those through the Cherry Hill Safe Streets program and the Southern Police District's Community Collaboration Unit, may be tempered due to budget cuts and staff reorganizations. Without funding for activities and events that helped build police-community relations and curtail some juvenile crime, police, organizations, and residents will have to develop new strategies to reduce crime. One strategy is to create a temporary recreation space

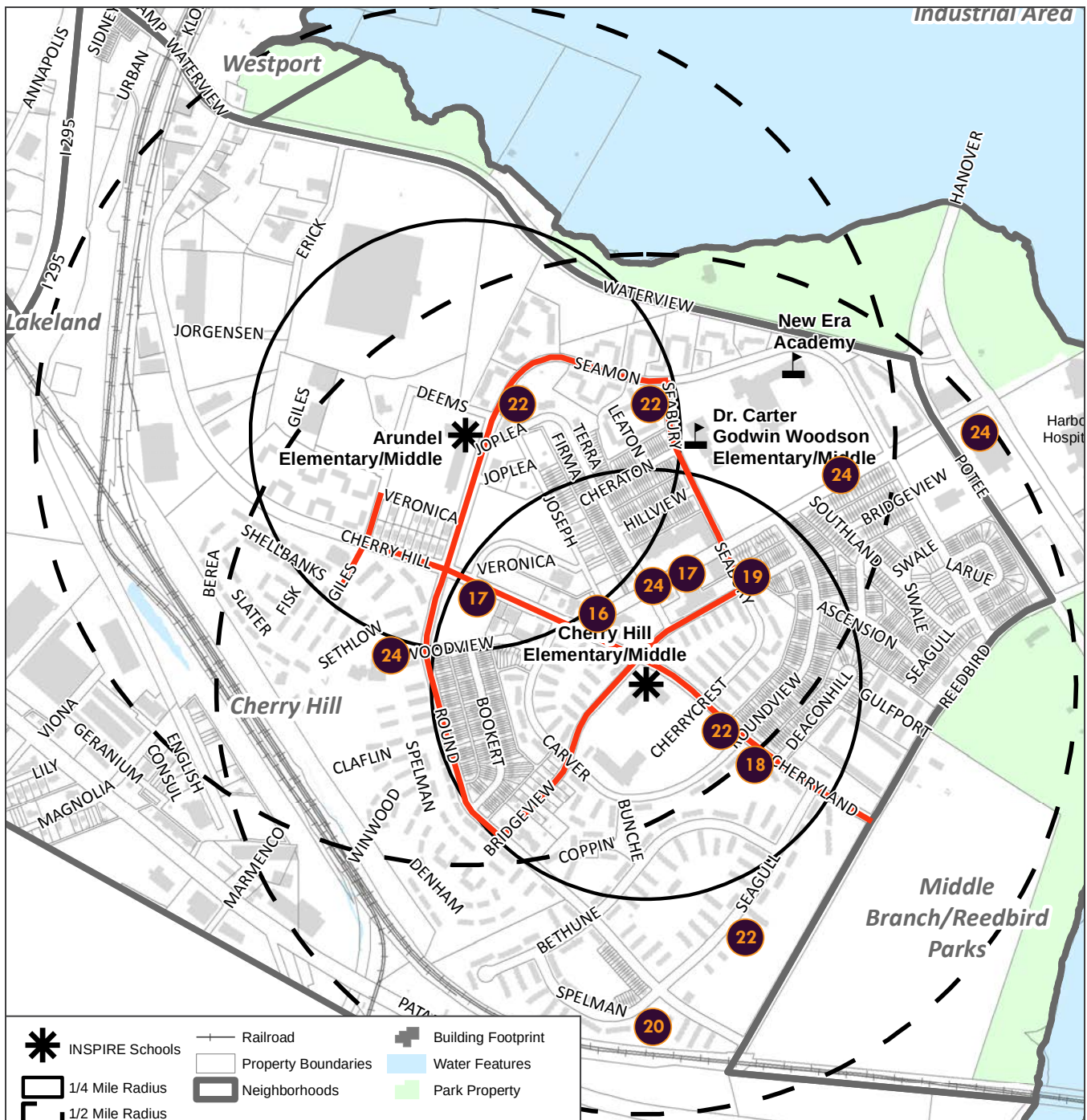
for teens and adults while the community's only recreation center is closed, to provide a safe and positive space to meet and be active. The community's Public Safety Committee should work closely with the police to develop other strategies.

16. Identify a location for a resiliency hub in Cherry Hill.

A resiliency hub is a building or set of buildings and neighboring outdoor space that will provide residents of a community with shelter, backup electricity, access to fresh water, and access to resources such as food, ice, charging stations, etc. in the event of an emergency. Resiliency hubs are located in well-utilized and trusted spaces. Ideally, the hubs will also include additional elements such as a place to grow fresh and local food, increased tree canopy for shade and cooling, accessibility to fresh and clean water, and resources for sheltering in place or evacuation as needed. The Public Safety Committee should work with the Department of Planning and Office of Sustainability (OS) to identify and set up a hub. The Committee can also work with OS to include neighborhood-specific recommendations in the Disaster Preparedness and Planning Project (DP3) update.

CREATE CONNECTIONS AND ACCESS

*Improve connections throughout the neighborhood
and between Cherry Hill and the rest of the city.*



Improve Walking Access and Safety in the Neighborhood



16. Make the intersection at Cherry Hill and Cherryland safer.

The community has identified the intersection at Cherry Hill and Cherryland as one that is unsafe due to the configuration of the streets and the traffic signal. DOT will review intersection crash data and develop short-term recommendations that might include traffic signal modifications, lane markings, bump-outs, and lane configuration changes.

17. Slow traffic on Cherry Hill Road between Giles and Seabury Roads.

Cars turning onto Cherry Hill Road – from Potee and Hanover at one end and Waterview at the other – often speed up the hill, leading past the schools and the Town Center. Students and residents report high speed traffic as a critical safety issue. DOT will conduct a speed study and look at the results to determine if and what changes should be made. Short-term measures might include speed cameras and speed humps; longer-term measures might include bump-outs or geometric changes.

18. Add missing sidewalks on well-traveled routes.

Missing sidewalks force people to cross the road or walk in the street, where they are more likely to be hit by a vehicle. A survey should be conducted by DOT. One location that DOT should assess is on Cherryland between Roundview Road and Deacon Hill.

19. Improve the connection from Seabury Avenue to Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School by way of Bridgeview Avenue.

Bridgeview Avenue is one of the main, less-trafficked, routes to Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School. For many residents, a popular path to access Bridgeview Avenue, and the southern portion of the neighborhood from Cherry Hill Road is through a vacant parcel adjacent to the Family Health Center and directly across from the Town Center at Seabury Avenue. The poorly maintained lot and informal path could be transformed through grading and landscaping. DOT and DOP are reviewing options, described below.



INSPIRE Community Project

Residents of Cherry Hill showed overwhelming support for the Department of Planning to use INSPIRE GO Bonds to make the vacant parcel adjacent to the Family Health Center and directly across from the Town Center at Seabury Avenue a landscaped, graded pathway. “Formalizing” this route is even more important since some children previously zoned for Carter G. Woodson will attend Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School, and taking this direct route keeps them from walking along the busier Cherry Hill Road. DOP is working with HCD and DOT to do the following:

- Reclaim the DOT right-of-way, where the informal path is, for an intentional and graded walking path.
- Landscape the vacant parcel, in partnership with community members, for a permanent attractive green space.

20. Make a safe crossing from Round Road and Spelman Avenue to the Patapsco Avenue shopping area.

The South Baltimore Gateway Master Plan presents the idea of a crossing over the CSX tracks for individuals in this part of the neighborhood who shop at the stores on Patapsco Avenue. DOT and CSX should consider safer ways of accessing these businesses.

21. Create a “walking school bus,” “bicycle train,” or “block captain” program.

With most students likely not qualifying for school bus pickup, measures should be taken to ensure safety for children during travel to and from school. The schools and parents should explore models and opportunities for walking school buses (a group of children walking with one or more adults), bicycle trains (a group of children biking with adults), and block captain programs. See Appendix C for more information.



Improve Street Infrastructure

22. Repair streets that are in poor condition.

The community has identified streets that are in significantly poor condition with broken paving or narrow right-of-ways. DOT will evaluate the following locations to determine if they are a priority for future paving seasons:

- The intersection of Seabury and Seamon
- The end of Joseph Avenue near Joplea Road

- The intersection of Roundview Road and Cherryland
- Seagull Avenue between Round Road and Cherryland



Increase and Improve Public Transportation

23. Improve access to public transportation.

Cherry Hill has been described by many residents as a walkable neighborhood, which is important given that a large percentage of the population does not have access to a vehicle (51 percent). Many residents rely on the Light Rail or bus to take them where they need to go. At the same time, under the State’s BaltimoreLink plan to improve bus service, changes to service in Cherry Hill are projected to help residents efficiently travel to and from work seven days a week.

Under BaltimoreLink, the frequency of service on Sundays sees significant improvements while preserving the current span of service. Chief among the frequency improvements is the CityLink Silver, which will have 20 minute frequency on Sunday, an improvement over the current roughly 45 minute frequency of the No. 64 route. While the replacements for the current crosstown No. 51 and No. 16 routes maintain their current Sunday frequency (roughly 35 minutes and 55 minutes respectively), the remain-

ing BaltimoreLink routes through Cherry Hill bring notable increases to Sunday transit frequency. The LocalLink 71 and LocalLink 73 routes combine for 20 minute frequencies on Sunday, which is an improvement over the current 30 minute frequency on the No. 27 route. The LocalLink 69 and LocalLink 70 inherit the current two branches of the No. 14 route, and combine for a roughly 30 minute frequency on Sunday as compared to the No. 14's roughly 85 minute frequency on Sundays currently.

One new way for residents to get around would be by establishing a shuttle service connecting the South Baltimore neighborhoods that are part of the South Baltimore Gateway Master Plan area, potentially funded through a casino Local Impact Grant. A locally funded and operated neighborhood shuttle service would be a welcome addition to the transit network of Baltimore, and could utilize our CityLink and Light Rail as transfer points to high-frequency service.

24. Upgrade or install covered bus shelters.

Residents stressed the need for upgraded and additional bus shelter locations. The sites listed below have been preliminarily reviewed by the MTA as sites for potential expansion of shelter amenities or new shelter locations. MTA will work in coordination with DOP and the community to identify mutually agreeable locations dependent on funding and right-of-way availability. The following are sites that have undergone preliminary review:

Existing Expansions

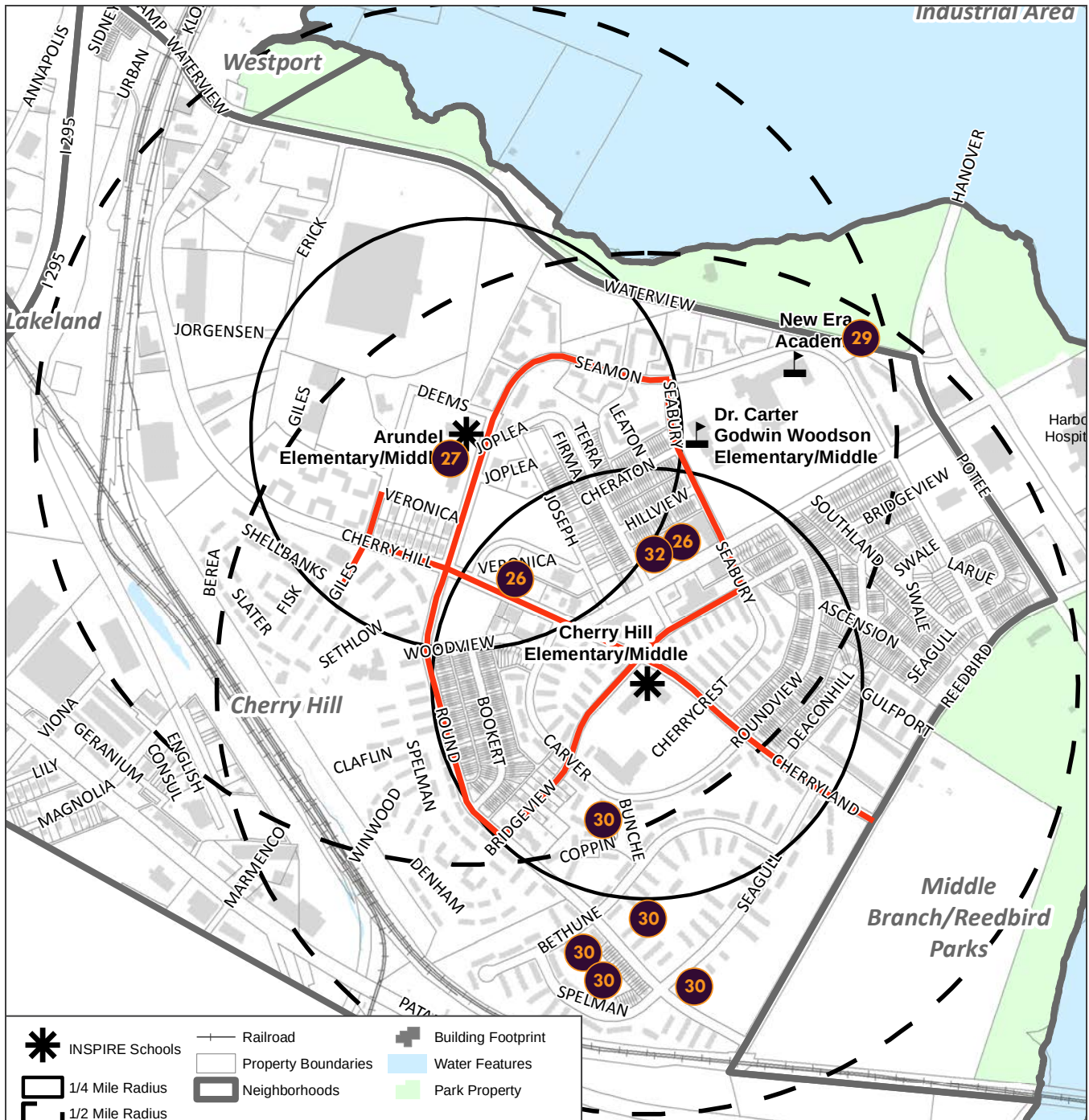
- Cherry Hill and Terra Firma Roads
- Woodview and Spelman Roads

New Additions

- Woodview and Spelman Roads (eastbound)
- Potee St. and Cherry Hill Rd. (southbound)
- Cherry Hill at Cherrydale Apartments
- Cherry Hill and Seabury Roads (westbound)
- Cherry Hill and Seabury Roads (eastbound)
- Shellbanks and Giles Roads (northbound)

CREATE OPPORTUNITIES FOR HEALTH AND WELLNESS

*Provide better access to healthy foods, expand recreational activities,
and increase community cohesion.*



Enhance the Healthy Food Environment

25. Open an affordable grocery store or grocery alternative that is conveniently located to serve Cherry Hill.

Accessing healthy and affordable food in Cherry Hill is a challenge for residents, and the neighborhood is considered a food desert. Many residents used to meet their grocery needs at a Walmart in Port Covington, but the store is now closed. Even reaching that location was a challenge for some households without access to a car. Today, the nearest supermarkets are on the South Baltimore peninsula or on West Patapsco Avenue across the CSX tracks near Lakeland. In the neighborhood, the Family Dollar in the Town Center offers a very limited selection of mostly processed foods while the Virtual Supermarket meets the needs of a limited number of households. A supermarket in Cherry Hill could serve residents in other nearby neighborhoods – Mt. Winans and Westport – which are also considered food deserts. As part of the City’s Food Desert Retail Strategy and in conjunction with the South Baltimore Gateway Master Plan, BDC is actively working on a grocery store site selection analysis for Cherry Hill. BDC is also exploring the feasibility of alternative grocery models, such as a community-owned cooperative, that may better serve Cherry Hill, given its unique geographic features and strong community engagement and participation.

26. Develop and implement a comprehensive food access strategy.

Securing affordable and healthy food access in Cherry Hill will require multiple methods. A comprehensive food access strategy should be developed by bringing together all of the organizations, businesses, and policymakers who participate in creating a healthy food environment in the neighborhood. Some of this is taking place, although somewhat independently. Working together these groups should develop a diverse system



to meet the community’s needs, including things such as community gardens, a mobile food market, a farmers’ market, healthy fast food retail, nutrition education. It is also worth exploring potential sites within the neighborhood to serve meals in times of weather or other emergencies. Currently the closest location is the Farring-Baybrook Recreation Center. Specific ideas include the following:

- Increasing the production at the Cherry Hill Urban Garden and expanding the hours for purchasing food
- Encouraging eligible residents to use online food ordering and delivery, as provided by programs like the Virtual Supermarket – including through the schools
- Working through BDC with retailers in the Town Center to help them offer more staple and fresh foods
- Engaging the Real Food Farm mobile market, which is funded through a South Baltimore Gateway Food Access mini-grant, to make a weekly stop at a central location in Cherry Hill

27. Use the schools as sites for meal programs.

Arundel has served meals to children after school, as well as beyond the academic school year through the Family League’s Summer Meals Food Program. Since the school is open during the summer, Arundel could also serve as a site for summer meals for other neighborhood residents, who are not served through other locations.

28. Expand the links between the schools and food and nutrition programs in the neighborhood.

There are many opportunities for the schools and neighborhood institutions to work together to improve the nutritional health of students and their families.

These are a few opportunities:

- The Cherry Hill Urban Garden – across the street from Arundel and a few blocks from Cherry Hill – could teach students about the food system through hands-on experience in the growing season, and co-host cooking workshops or potlucks with the schools. Two examples of gardens with effective programming are the Filbert Street Garden in Curtis Bay and Whitelock Farm in Reservoir Hill.
- MedStar Harbor Hospital could continue to facilitate parent healthy cooking workshops with the American Heart Association, and operate other nutrition programs
- Neighborhood churches could operate nutrition programs, and open their kitchens to the garden or schools for cooking classes, workshops, or potlucks



Improve Recreational Opportunities

29. Improve the connection from the neighborhood to the waterfront and Middle Branch Park.

Previous studies of the neighborhood have shown the importance of an easy and safe connection from the

neighborhood to the park, without having to descend 100 feet along Cherry Hill Road. A logical place for such a connection would be along the sidewalk at the most northern point of Seamon Avenue, where pedestrians cross unsafely at-grade now. In addition, no sidewalk exists on the north side of Waterview along this section of the park. DOT and BCRP will review options to provide a safe crossing. Solutions could range from traffic calming efforts to a pedestrian signal.



30. Upgrade poorly-maintained playground equipment.

Certain playgrounds in the neighborhood have, or are becoming, rundown and need to be restored. The community or schools might consider working with KaBOOM! to organize walks in the community to prioritize areas. Many sites are on HABC property, and HABC plans to renovate eight in spring 2017:

- 3401 Spelman Rd.
- 847, 1020, and 1033 Bethune Rd.
- 901 Coppin Ct.
- 918 Seagull Ave.
- 3439 Road Rd.
- 837 Roundview Rd.

Other locations should be evaluated, including:

- 1100 and 1200 Cherry Hill Rd.
- Shellbanks and Blyden Rds.
- 2600-block of Carver Rd.
- 288-block of Spelman Rd.
- 2700-block of Fisk Rd.

31. Improve trails and walking paths.

Residents have expressed interest in being able to safely exercise in their neighborhood. Two ways to meet this interest are by improving the Gwynns Falls Trail and by creating a purposeful walking route in the neighborhood.

- Sections of the Gwynns Falls Trail walking paths that are closest to Cherry Hill –where the trail comes under Potee Street and along the southern edge of Reedbird Park– are poorly maintained, and collapsed in certain areas. Repairing these sections would make it possible for residents and others to use the trail for exercise and recreation. Community members also noted the loss of a park ranger along the trail. Consideration should be given to use Casino Impact Grant funds to staff this position.
- The Department of Health and MedStar Harbor Hospital have begun to explore designating a “medical mile” walking path between Harbor Hospital and the Family Health Center.



Improve Community Cohesion

32. Provide benches and public gathering spaces at the Town Center.

The Town Center is a central gathering space in Cherry Hill. However, there is not space for neighbors to sit and meet with each other so that the Town Center acts as a true town square. Many residents have voiced interest in having the Town Center owners provide benches or other spaces that allow for and encourage community interaction.

33. Install plaques to showcase leaders and success stories.

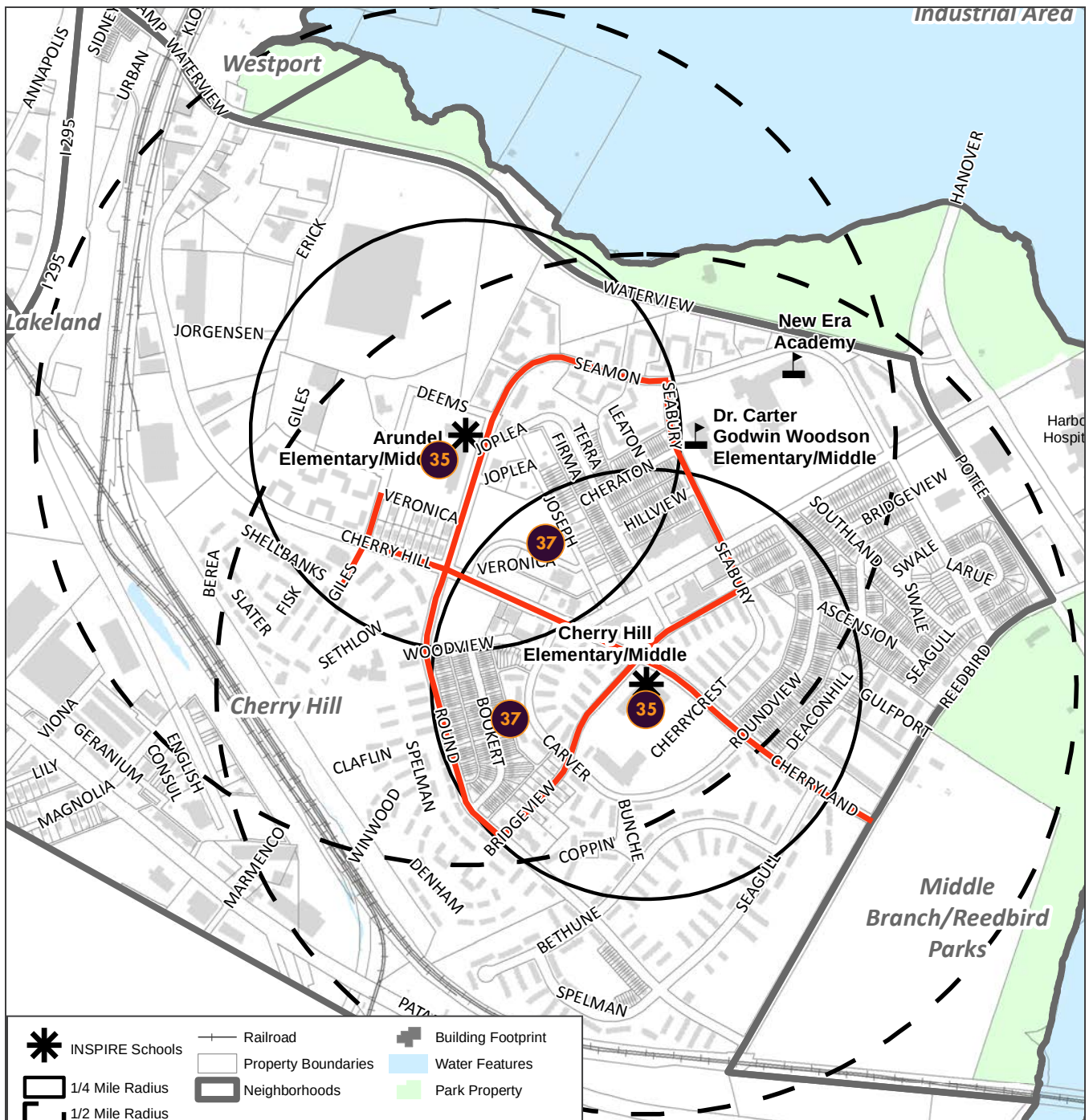
Residents of Cherry Hill are proud of the people that have come from their neighborhood. Plaques or signage throughout the community would teach and inspire current and future generations about the important contributions residents have made. Community members can work with DOP's Commission for Historical and Architectural Preservation.

34. Install additional neighborhood signs.

Community signs are posted on the southbound side of Potee Street and along Cherry Hill Road adjacent to Cherry Hill Homes. To further identify Cherry Hill as an important Baltimore neighborhood, other locations at community entryways could be added, especially along Waterview Avenue and Cherry Hill Road. DOT has a program that provides assistance for neighborhood identification signs.

CREATE AN ENVIRONMENTALLY-SUSTAINABLE AND CLEAN NEIGHBORHOOD

Improve the natural environment.



Create a Clean and Green Neighborhood



35. Explore opportunities for Arundel and Cherry Hill to become “Green Schools.”

Significant opportunities exist for the schools to adopt sustainability education and best practices in order to reach regionally- or nationally- recognized “Green School” designations (e.g. Maryland Association for Environmental and Outdoor Education Green School and Sustainable School (MAEOE); US Dept. of Education Green Ribbon; US Green Building Council’s Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design). Both schools have participated in environmentally-focused activities; neither has demonstrated significant integration of school-wide sustainability programming.

The Green, Healthy, Smart Challenge and the Baltimore Energy Challenge are two local funding opportunities to develop capacity in greening projects. Arundel participated in the Baltimore Energy Challenge in SY 15-16. Funding from these grants could pay for materials needed to meet program requirements such as recycling bins and posters for starting a recycling club, gardening supplies, or teacher professional development workshops. Increased funding is provided for schools applying to become Maryland Certified Green Schools and those that have received that designation from the MAEOE.

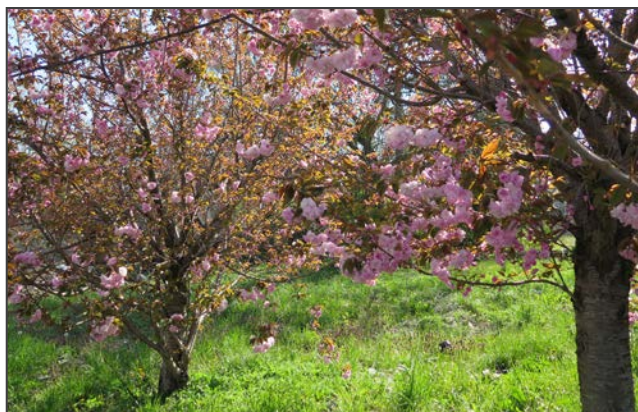
The schools’ proximity to the vibrant natural resources of Middle Branch and Reedbird parks and the Patapsco

River allow opportunity for rich environmental programming for students. Schools should partner with organizations such as Masonville Cove Environmental Center and BCRP’s Outdoor Recreation Team to attain meaningful watershed experiences for students on land and on the water. Additional maritime and marine-related partners include Living Classrooms, the Chesapeake Bay Foundation, and the National Aquarium. Schools should incorporate a staple watershed experience for every student at a particular grade level (e.g. all fourth graders will go on a Living Classrooms boat trip or all seventh graders will conduct a clean-up on the Patapsco in canoes with BCRP). Local Impact Grant funds for environmental education have been earmarked for grants to schools for project development in addition to staff support by a coordinator to further connect with the area’s natural resources.

Additional strategies for creating sustainable green communities can be found in the BCPS Sustainability Plan and the Baltimore Sustainability Plan.

36. Increase the street tree canopy.

Certain streets in the INSPIRE area could benefit from additional trees. Residents and other stakeholders are interested in bringing back cherry blossom or other flowering trees, to make the streets more inviting and to better stitch together the neighborhood. Flowering trees will be planted along Cherry Hill Road in spring 2017 (See map in Appendix A). Other locations near the bottom of Round Road and Seagull Avenue should be considered for stormwater mitigation.



Address Trash and Dumping Problems



37. Use code enforcement to address illegal dumping and clean up hotspots and dirty alleys.

Overall, the INSPIRE area is fairly clean. There are, however, a few spots that are targets for illegal dumping of debris. In addition to residents reporting dumping to the 311 system, the community should work with the Department of Housing and Community Development's Code Enforcement Division to identify solutions for repeat dumping sites, including:

- 2800-blocks of Joseph and Veronica Avenues
- Alleys behind 2700-block of Bookert Drive

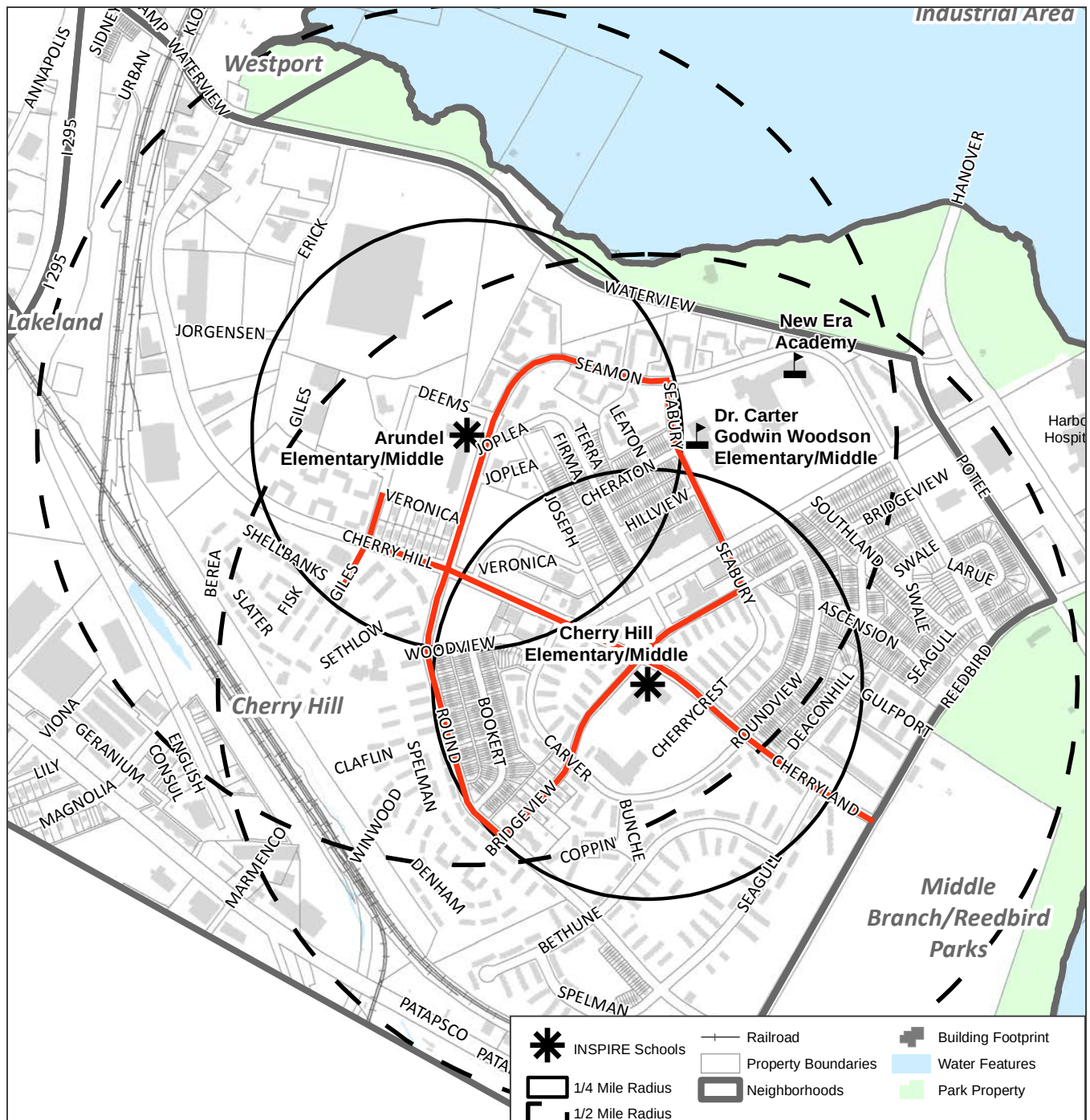
38. Develop community-led initiatives to address trash and litter problems.

Household trash is not always properly put out for pick-up, and is instead piled in alleys. Litter can be a problem as well, and this debris collects in certain areas of the neighborhood. The community should develop new community-led initiatives to educate residents about proper storage of trash and recycling and when it can be put out for pick-up, in addition to litter education. Examples of initiatives include neighborhood adoption of trash cans in key areas, organizing block clean-ups, and coordinating reporting and tracking of problem properties through the City's 311 system. The City will soon be rolling out a program that can work with the schools, organizations, and businesses to develop school or community-led strategies.



PROVIDE OPPORTUNITIES FOR ECONOMIC SELF-SUFFICIENCY

Expand employment and workforce development opportunities.



Provide Training and Access to Jobs

39. Ensure that new and expanding businesses hire from the neighborhood.

To implement this recommendation, it would be important for the neighborhood leadership to identify those residents seeking employment and ensure that their skills are well documented. These individuals should then register with the Mayor's Office of Employment Development (MOED) so that they are in the City system should MOED be asked to identify potential workers for a new or expanding business.

40. Tailor job training for placement at Under Armour and Harbor Hospital.

The Employment Connection Center on Bush Street, which serves South and Southwest Baltimore, should continue to work with these major employers to match the projected needs for jobs with the skill training required for local residents. MOED has entered into a memorandum of understanding with Sagamore Development to support local hiring efforts for the New Port Covington Project that will include the new UA Campus. Sagamore Development will work with MOED, other partners and a workforce intermediary to identify and screen candidates for various aspects of the Port Covington project. Sagamore will fund a local Hiring Coordinator position to implement the local hiring law, work with the workforce intermediary, and other stakeholders.

41. Address the barrier to employment for people with criminal records.

Through its public safety committee, the Cherry Hill Community Coalition will provide resources for those who have minor offenses on their records to have those records expunged.

42. Develop a landscape/nursery training program for youth.

While funds continue to be allocated for planting trees and other vegetation in the area through Recreation and Parks and Blue Water Baltimore, maintenance of these plantings is always an issue. Several nonprofits, such as Blue Water Baltimore, Parks and People, and Civic Works currently offer trainings in plant maintenance, and could develop a curriculum, along with BCRP, to train young people who join the program to learn advanced skills that would prepare them for careers in the landscape and nursery field.

43. Develop career path programs in the transportation/logistics field.

With the proximity of the Port and its operations to Cherry Hill, and the number of jobs in Port-related businesses, a memorandum of agreement exists among several of these organizations to provide guidance in developing a curriculum and training that will prepare young people (and adults) for jobs and careers in this industry.

STRENGTHEN PARTNERSHIPS AND SOCIAL CONNECTIONS

Expand and create relationships and partnerships in the neighborhood.

A number of recommendations came out of the planning process that are aimed at strengthening the social fabric of the community. These are important for maintaining and improving the quality of life for Cherry Hill's residents. Many of these recommendations intersect with those mentioned earlier in the plan, but do not necessarily involve City agencies.

Strengthen the Connection between Residents, the Retail and Community Facilities, and Community-based Organizations

- Have an Advisory Board for tenants selection of local businesses in Town Center
- Expand faith-based community activities (mentor at schools, have health fairs, prayer walks, focus on healthy foods, etc.)
- Strengthen family and community ties in the neighborhood
- Strengthen collaborations between community organizations and the schools
- Teach kids, families, and other residents how to row and swim through programming at the recreation center and Rowing Club

Expand Recreational Programming

- Create partnerships to increase programming and activity in Middle Branch Park
- Create more effective communication about what's happening/opportunities for people to be involved

Address Education/School/Family/Student Needs

- Bring the families from all three schools (including Carter G. Woodson) together before opening day

- Pay senior citizen mentors/tutors for elementary schools
- Expand/enhance after-school programs to keep kids busy from 3-6 p.m. (Boys and Girls Club); help middle school students see alternatives/shift attitudes; include homework time/preparation kids for tests
- Improve Enoch Pratt Library and coordinate resources with schools
- Expand Head Start
- Help families to better participate in getting children prepared; improve parent involvement. Help families flourish
- Address social/emotional needs, including chronic absences
- Continue to expand the infants-through-community college-jobs approach, including developing relationships with Ben Franklin at Masonville Cove High School in Brooklyn

Market Cherry Hill

- Partner with different media to show the positive things in the community and schools
- Create/expand community newsletter
- Create "one voice" –unity among community partners/ churches/ neighborhood stakeholders
- Develop community pride through an external marketing campaign
- Effectively communicate what's happening in the neighborhood/ opportunities for people to be involved

Plan Implementation

INSPIRE plans are already beginning to be implemented. Although not everything can happen right away, the Department of Planning is committed to continuing to work with community members to see recommendations become reality.

The Department of Planning, community stakeholders, and others should continuously refer to this section to hold each other accountable. This section:

- **Sets forth a desired time frame for implementation**
- **Identifies lead and support agencies/organizations**
- **Estimates the cost of implementation and identified or potential funding sources**
- **Identifies commitments already made**

As part of completing the plan, City agencies have already made some funding and staffing commitments. Complete implementation however, will require more resources.

We believe that the significant investment in Frederick Elementary School, in addition to the commitments represented in these tables, can encourage additional resources.

Timeframe

Short: 0-2 years

Medium: 3-5 years

Long: 5+ years

Estimated Cost of Improvements

\$ = \$5,000 or less

\$\$ = \$5,001-\$50,000

\$\$\$ = \$50,001-\$250,000

\$\$\$\$ = \$250,001 - \$500,000

\$\$\$\$\$ = More than \$500,000

Lead Responsibility

(for funding, advocacy, implementation)

Baltimore City Agencies

BCPD: Baltimore City Police Department

BDC: Baltimore Development Corporation

DGS: Department of General Services

HCD: Dept. of Housing and Community Development

DOP: Department of Planning

DPW: Department of Public Works

BCRP: Department of Recreation and Parks

DOT: Department of Transportation

Other

Private: Philanthropy, anchor institutions, investors, etc.

Community: Residents, Community-Based Organizations (CBOs), groups, businesses, etc.

LDC: local Development Council

SBGP: South Baltimore Gateway Partnership

Implementing Standard Improvements

Agencies have committed to making these improvements in time
for the re-opening of the school buildings.

Recommendations & Actions	Timeframe	Lead Responsibility	Estimated Cost	Funding
Repair sidewalk and curb deficiencies	By summer 2018	DOT	\$\$\$\$	INSPIRE GO Bonds, DOT
Assess need to repair ADA ramps at intersections	By summer 2018	DOT	TBD	DOT
Dig tree pits	By summer 2018	DOT	\$\$	INSPIRE GO Bonds
Repaint or add crosswalks	By SY 2018-19	DOT	\$\$	DOT
Assess crossing guard allocation	Before SY and in first weeks	DOT	N/A	N/A
Asses speed near school and along primary routes	By SY 2018-19	DOT	N/A	N/A
Install school signage /Replace or repair as needed	By SY 2018-19	DOT	\$	DOT
Post speed signs and speed sentry	1-2 weeks before and after school opening	DOT	N/A	N/A
Replace street light bulbs with LED bulbs	TBD	DOT	TBD	DOT
Conduct Safe Routes to School Training	Before SY or in first weeks	DOT	N/A	N/A
Remove and replace dead street trees	Summer-Fall 2018	BCRP	\$\$	BCRP
Plant new street trees	Summer-Fall 2018	BCRP	\$\$	BCRP, INSPIRE GO Bonds, LDC, SBGP
Proactive pruning	Ongoing	BCRP	\$	BCRP
Board vacant and accessible properties	By SY 18-19; Ongoing	HCD, DPW	\$	HCD, DPW
Clean and mow vacant lots	By SY 18-19; Ongoing	HCD, DPW	\$	HCD, DPW
Conduct a Clean Sweep along entire primary walking routes	Summer 2018	DPW	\$	DPW
Conduct regular code enforcement sweeps along the primary walking routes	Ongoing	DPW	N/A	HCD

Implementing Arundel and Cherry Hill Area Recommendations

Projects with at least some funding commitments are italicized.

Invest in Housing and Market-Strengthening Development Opportunities

Recommendation & Actions	Timeframe	Lead Responsibility	Estimated Cost	Potential Funding
Increase Quality Housing Options				
1. Develop a range of mixed-income housing for rent and ownership.				
<i>2800- and 2900-blocks of Joseph Ave. and Joplea Rd.</i>	Short	Private, DOP	\$\$\$\$\$	Private
2490 Giles Rd. 820	Long	Comptroller, Community	\$\$\$\$\$	Capital, Private
800-block Roundview Rd.	Long	Private, Community, HABC, HCD	\$\$\$\$\$	Private, HUD
Cherry Hill Rd. (Fisher's Cove)	Long	Private, Community, HABC, HCD	\$\$\$\$\$	Private, HUD
2. Promote homeownership assistance programs to help current and new owners maintain their homes.				
<i>Connect homeowners with programs available through Baltimore Housing's Green, Healthy and Sustainable Homes division by sharing program information at community association meetings, community events, and through the school.</i>	Ongoing	HCD, Community	\$	Operating Budget
<i>Promote the Baltimore Energy Challenge to educate homeowners about lowering energy bills by sharing program information at community meetings etc.</i>	Ongoing	HCD, Community	\$	Operating Budget
3. Improve the quality of public housing and the living situation for public housing residents.	Ongoing	HABC, Private	\$\$\$\$\$	
Promote Strategic Redevelopment Opportunities				
4. Determine potential short-term uses of Fisher's Cove site.	Short-Medium	Community, HABC, BDC, Private	TBD	TBD
5. Make improvements to the exterior façade and design of the Town Center.	Short	BDC, Private	TBD	Private, Grants
6. Continue to explore the reuse of the Carter G. Woodson school building.	Short	City Space Utilization Committee, HCD	TBD	TBD
7. Ensure that the owner of the property at 2800 Joplea Avenue keeps it well-maintained prior to its development.	Short	Private	\$	Private
8. Reuse 2490 Giles Road to meet community-identified needs.	Short-Medium	Comptroller, Community	\$\$\$\$\$	
9. Explore opportunities to temporarily reuse and redevelop the former BGE site and other properties near the Town Center for new businesses.	Medium-Long	BDC, Private, Community, BGE, DOP	TBD	TBD
10. Make efforts to attract transit-oriented development opportunities adjacent to the Light Rail station on Cherry Hill Road.	Medium-Long	BDC, Private, HCD, DOP	\$\$\$\$\$	
11. Determine temporary uses for vacant HABC properties along 800- and 900-blocks Reedbird Avenue (C.K. Anderson site).	Short-Medium	Community, HABC, HCD, Private,	TBD	
12. Create opportunities for business incubation.	Short		\$\$\$\$\$	TBD

Improve Safety

Recommendation & Actions	Timeframe	Lead Responsibility	Estimated Cost	Potential Funding
Promote Safety at Key Locations				
13. Improve lighting and security around the Light Rail tunnel and deter drug activity.	Short	DOT, MTA, BCPD	\$\$\$\$\$	TBD
14. Southern Police District police and the community should expand partnerships to prevent and reduce crime, especially among juveniles.	Short, Ongoing	Community, BCPD, DOP	TBD	TBD
15. Identify a location for a resiliency hub in Cherry Hill.	Short-Medium	Community, DOP/ Sustainability	TBD	TBD

Create Connections and Access

Recommendation & Actions	Timeframe	Lead Responsibility	Estimated Cost	Potential Funding
Improve Walking Access and Safety in the Neighborhood				
16. Make the intersection at Cherry Hill and Cherryland safer.	Short	DOT, Community	\$\$-\$	General Fund
17. Slow traffic on Cherry Hill Road between Giles and Seabury Roads.	Medium	DOT	\$\$	Capital Budget
18. Add missing sidewalks on well-traveled routes. Include Cherryland between Roundview Rd. and Deacon Hill.	Short	DOT	TBD	Capital Budget
19. Improve the connection from Seabury Avenue to Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School by way of Bridgeview Avenue.	Short	DOT, DPW	TBD	INSPIRE GO Bonds, Capital Budget
20. Make a safe crossing from Round Road and Spelman Avenue to the Patapsco Avenue shopping area.	Long	DOT, CSX	\$\$\$\$\$	Capital Budget
21. Create a “walking school bus,” “bicycle train,” or “block captain” program.	Ongoing	Schools, Community, DOH	N/A	N/A
Improve Street Infrastructure				
22. Repair streets that are in poor condition. - Intersection of Seabury and Seamon - End of Joseph Avenue near Joplea Rd. - Intersection of Roundview and Cherryland - Seagull Ave., between Round and Cherryland	Medium-Long	DOT, DPW	TBD	Capital Budget
Increase and Improve Public Transportation				
22. Improve access to public transportation.				
Expand Sunday transit service	Short	MTA	TBD	TBD
Establish a shuttle service connecting the South Baltimore neighborhoods that are part of the South Baltimore Gateway Master Plan	Short	MTA, DOT	TBD	TBD
24. Upgrade or install covered bus shelters. MTA Office of Service Development will undertake additional analysis and review of the following sites: - Cherry Hill and Terra Firma Roads - Woodview and Spelman Roads - Woodview and Spelman Roads (eastbound) - Potee St. and Cherry Hill Rd. (southbound) - Cherry Hill at Cherrydale Apartments - Cherry Hill and Seabury Roads (westbound) - Cherry Hill and Seabury Roads (eastbound) - Shellbanks and Giles Roads (northbound)	Short-Medium	TBD	TBD	Capital Budget

Create Opportunities for Health and Wellness

Recommendation & Actions	Timeframe	Lead Responsibility	Estimated Cost	Potential Funding
Enhance the Healthy Food Environment				
25. Open an affordable grocery store or grocery alternative that is conveniently located to serve Cherry Hill.	Medium	BDC, Private	\$\$\$\$\$	TBD
26. Develop and implement a comprehensive food access strategy.				
Increase the production at the Cherry Hill Urban Garden and expand the hours for purchasing food	Short	Community, DOH	TBD	TBD
Encourage eligible residents to use online food ordering and delivery, as provided by programs like the Virtual Supermarket – including through the schools	Ongoing	DOH, Schools, Community	N/A	N/A
Work through BDC with retailers in the Town Center to help them offer more staple and fresh foods	Short	BDC, Private, Community	\$	LDC
<i>Engage the Real Food Farm mobile market, which is funded through a South Baltimore Gateway Food Access mini-grant, to make a weekly stop at a central location in Cherry Hill.</i>	Short, Ongoing	Community, Schools	\$	LDC
27. Use the schools as sites for meal programs.	Short, Ongoing	Schools	\$	TBD
28. Create or expand the links between the schools and food and nutrition programs in the neighborhood.	Short, Ongoing	Schools, Community, DOH	\$	TBD
Cherry Hill Urban Garden to work with the schools				
<i>MedStar Harbor Hospital to facilitate healthy cooking workshops and other nutrition programs</i>	Ongoing	Private/MedStar	\$	Private
Improve Recreational Opportunities				
29. Improve the connection from the neighborhood to the waterfront and Middle Branch Park.	Medium	DOT, BCRP	\$\$\$-\$\$\$\$	LDC, SBGP
30. Upgrade poorly-maintained playground equipment.				
<i>HABC plans to renovate these playgrounds in 2017:</i> • 3401 Spelman Rd. • 847, 1020, and 1033 Bethune Rd. • 901 Coppin Ct. • 918 Seagull Ave. • 3439 Round Rd. • 837 Roundview Rd.	Short	HABC	\$\$\$\$	Capital Budget
Other locations should be evaluated: • 1100 and 1200 Cherry Hill Rd. • Shellbanks Rd. & Blyden • 2600-block of Carver Rd. • 288-block of Spelman Rd. • 2700-block of Fisk Rd.	Medium	HABC, Community, BCRP	TBD	Capital Budget, SBGP, SB7
31. Improve trails and walking paths.				
Repair sections of the Gwynns Falls Trail	Medium	BCRP	\$\$\$-\$\$\$\$\$	Capital Budget
Create a “medical mile” between MedStar Harbor Hospital and the Family Health Center	Short	DOH, Private	\$-\$	TBD
Improve Community Cohesion				
32. Provide benches and public gathering spaces at the Town Center.	Short	Private	TBD	SBGP, Private
33. Install plaques to showcase leaders and success stories.	Short	Community, DOP/CHAP	TBD	SBGP, LDC
34. Install additional neighborhood signs. • Along Waterview Ave. and Cherry Hill Rd.	Short	Community	TBD	Community, Capital Budget, Philanthropy

Create an Environmentally-Sustainable and Clean Neighborhood

Recommendation & Actions	Timeframe	Lead Responsibility	Estimated Cost	Potential Funding
Create a Clean and Green Neighborhood				
35. Explore opportunities for Arundel and Cherry Hill to become “Green Schools,” using the surrounding neighborhood for projects.	Ongoing	Schools, DOP/ Sustainability, BCPS, Community	N/A	N/A
36. Increase the street tree canopy in the community.	Short-Medium	BCRP, Community/Blue Water Baltimore	TBD	Private Capital
Address Trash and Dumping Problems				
37. Use code enforcement to address illegal dumping and clean up dumping hotspots and dirty alleys. - Joseph Ave. and Veronica Ave. (camera present) - Alleys behind 2700-block of Bookert Dr.	Short, Ongoing	HCD, DPW, Community	\$	Operating Budget
38. Develop community-led initiatives to address trash and litter problems.	Short, Ongoing	Community, DPW, Schools	\$	Grants, Operating

Provide Opportunities for Economic Self-Sufficiency

Recommendation & Actions	Timeframe	Lead Responsibility	Estimated Cost	Potential Funding
Provide Training and Access to Jobs				
39. Ensure that new and expanding businesses hire from the neighborhood.	Ongoing	MOED, BDC, Community	\$\$\$	SBGP, TBD
40. Tailor job training for placement at Under Armour and Harbor Hospital.	Short, Ongoing	MOED, Private	\$\$\$	LDC, SBGP
41. Address the barrier to employment for people with criminal records.	Ongoing	Community, MOED	TBD	TBD
42. Develop a landscape/nursery training program for youth.	Short-Ongoing	Community/Blue Water Baltimore, MOED,	TBD	SBGP
43. Develop career path programs in the transportation/logistics field.	Short-Ongoing	Community, MOED, New Era, Port Maritime Trades Program	TBD	TBD

Appendix A: Maps

Zoning

Development Opportunity Sites

Tree Planting Sites

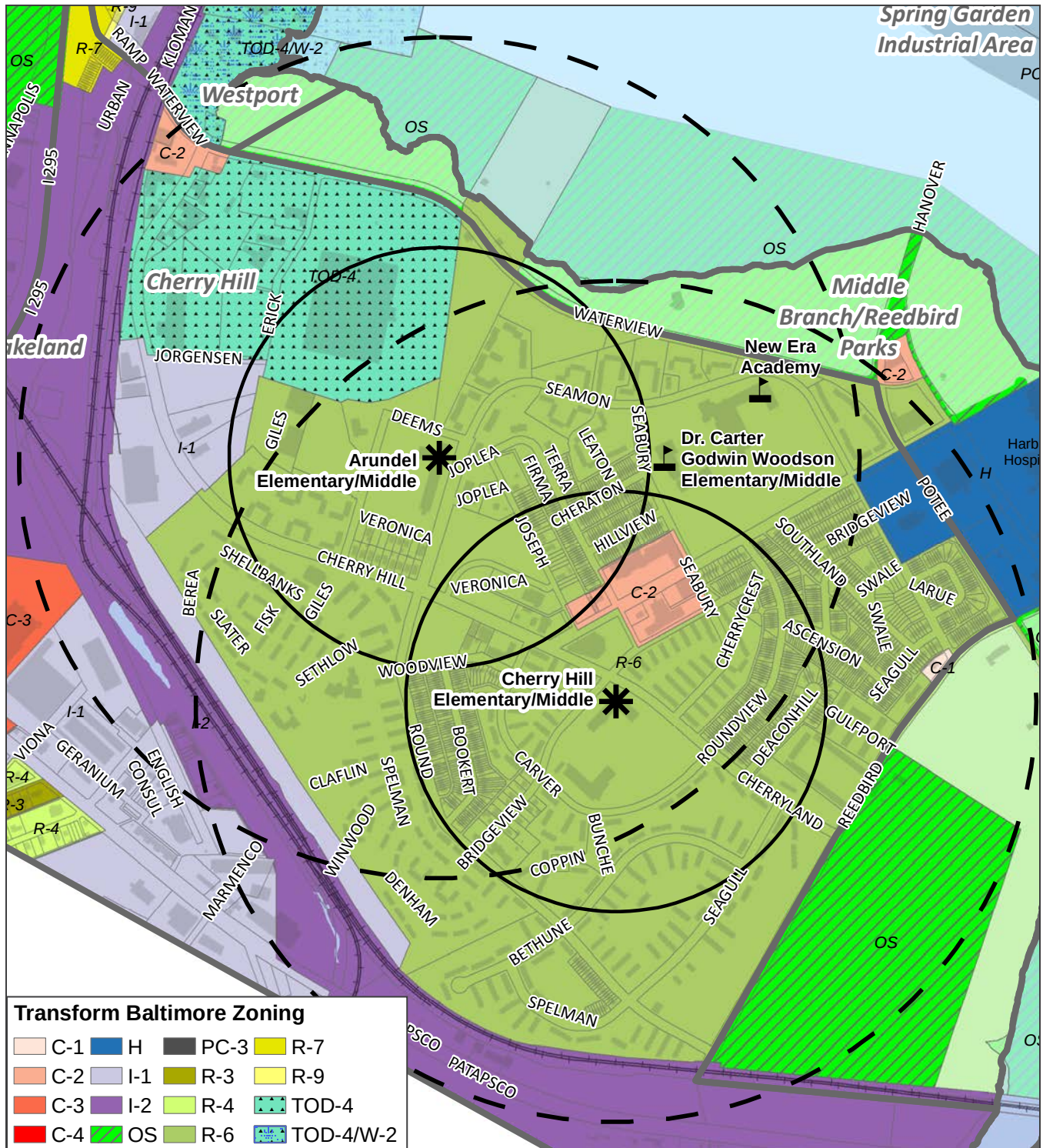
Food Environment

311 Calls - Dirty Streets and Alleys

Part 1 Crime Incidents

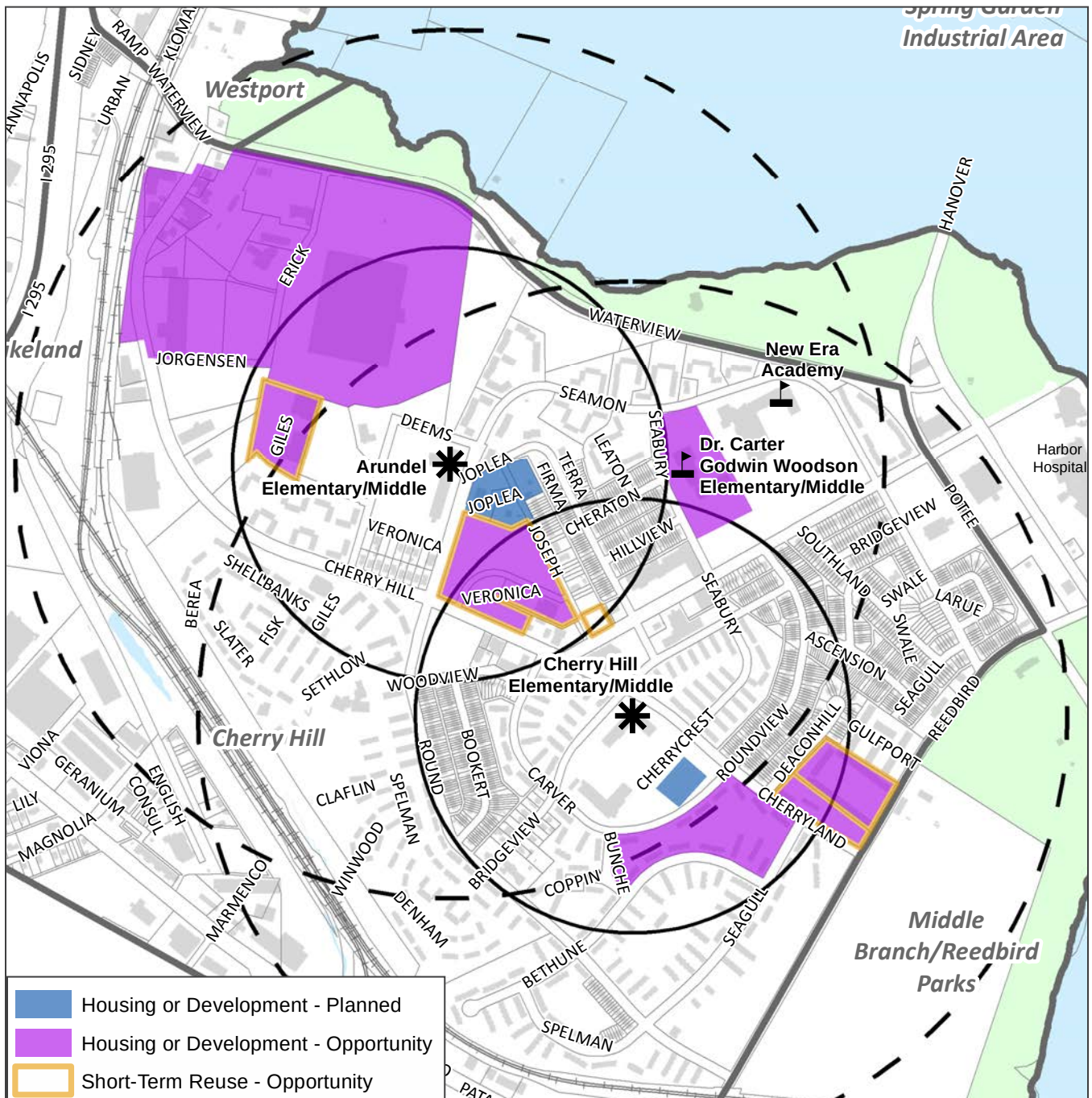
Zoning

This map reflects new zoning categories, as defined in Transform Baltimore. These new zoning categories allow for a mix of open space, residential, commercial, and transit-oriented development near Middle Branch Park and the Light Rail Station. MedStar Harbor Hospital has been designated with a new zoning category – hospital campus zoning.



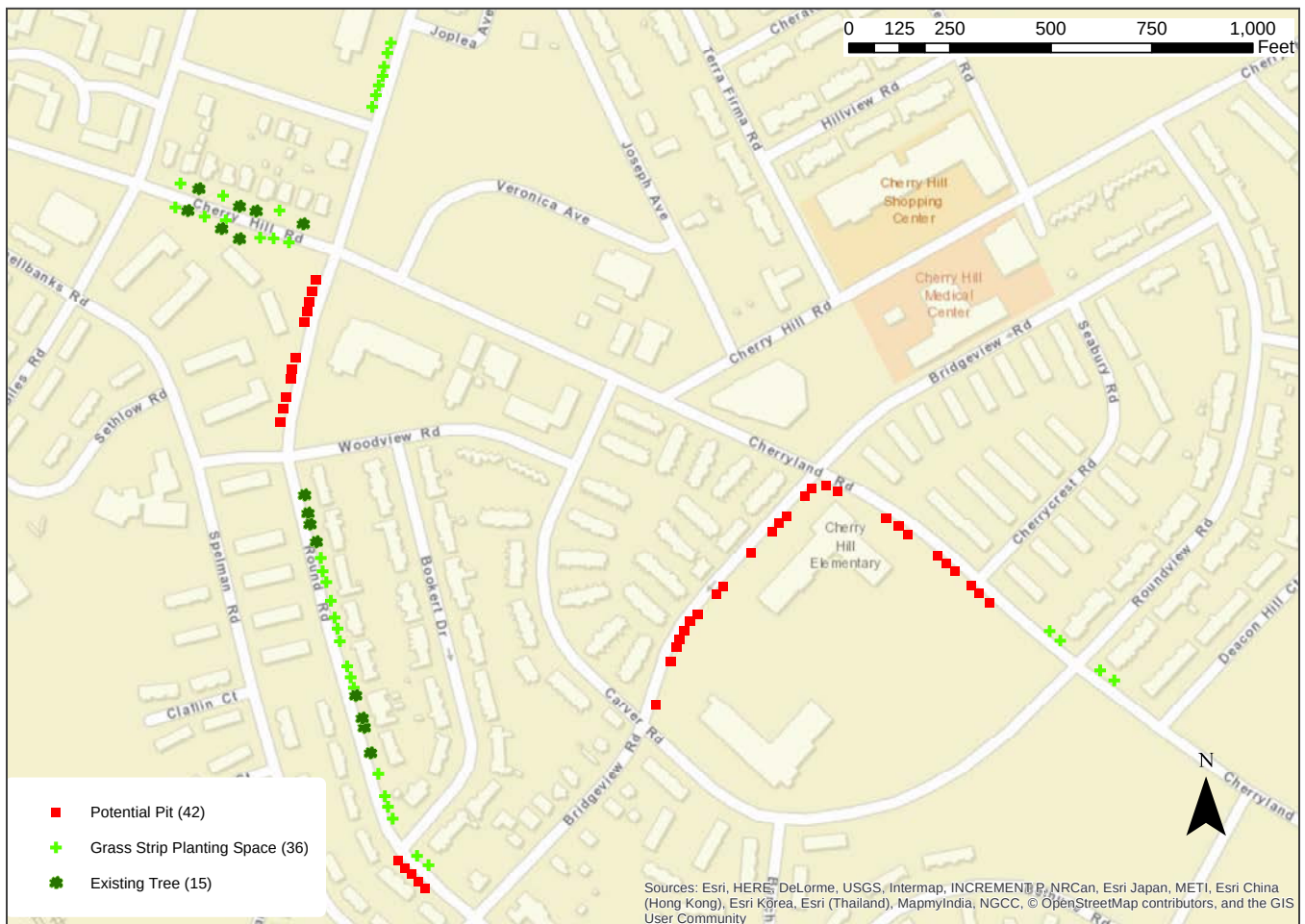
Development Opportunity Sites

This map shows prime temporary land reuse opportunities, and long-term housing or development opportunities in Cherry Hill, as described in the Plan.



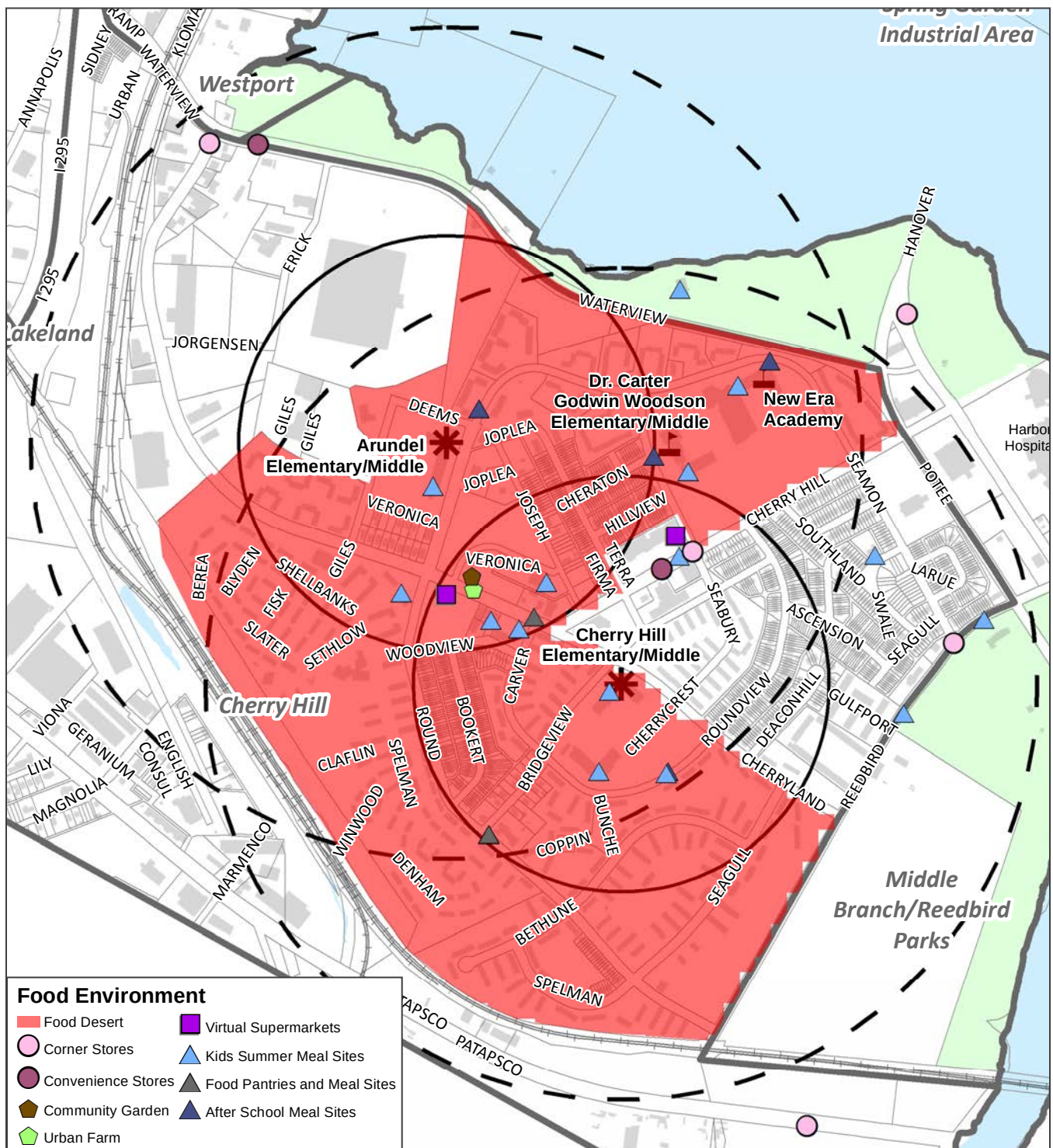
Tree Planting Sites

This map shows potential tree planting sites for “Phase 1 planting ” in Cherry Hill, as assessed by Tree Baltimore. Further assessment will take place to determine final and future sites. Tree Baltimore and Blue Water Baltimore’s Deep Blue program will share responsibility for planting.



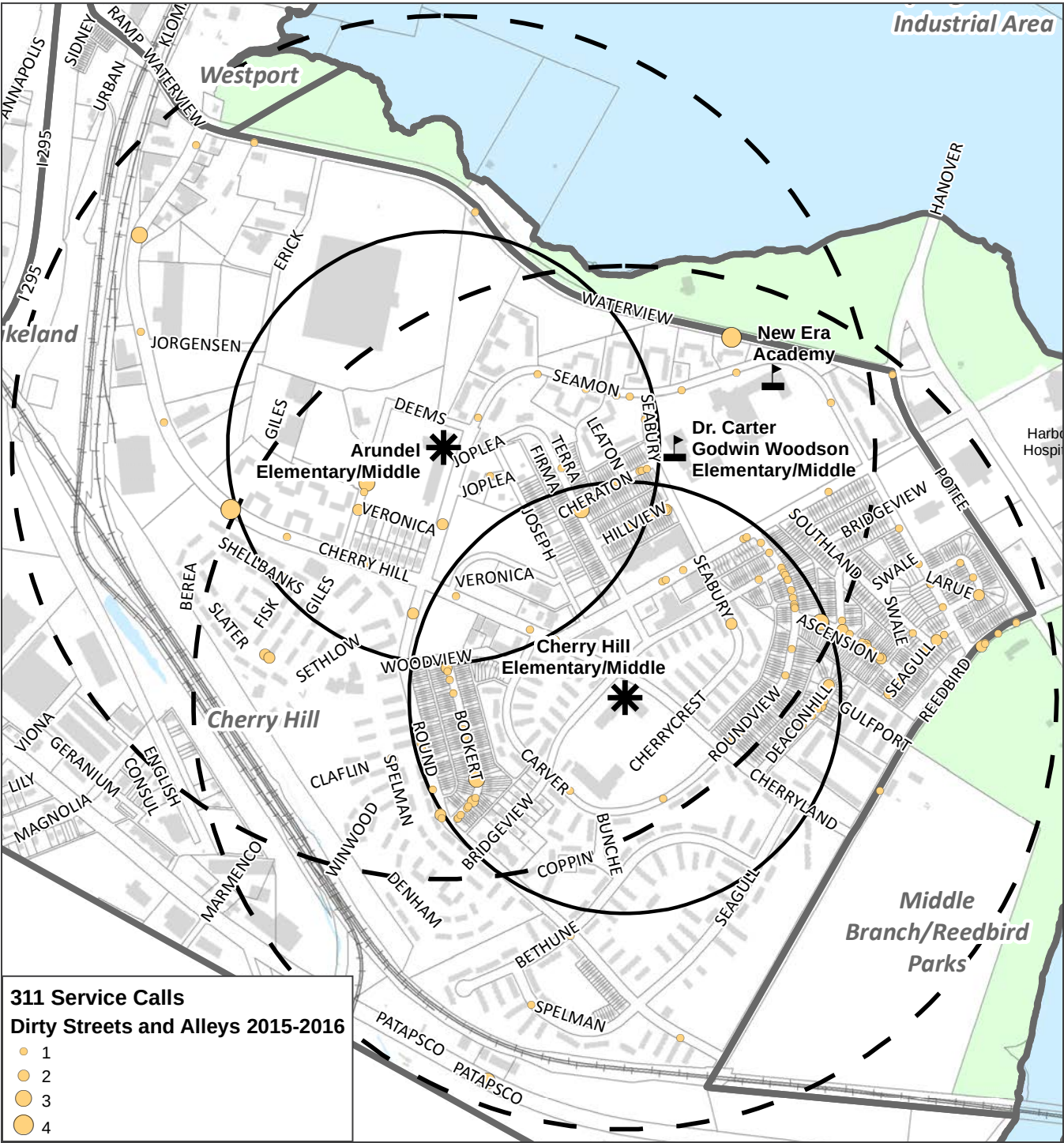
Food Environment

The Food Environment Map includes food retail, food assistance, and food production. It does not include establishments such as restaurants.



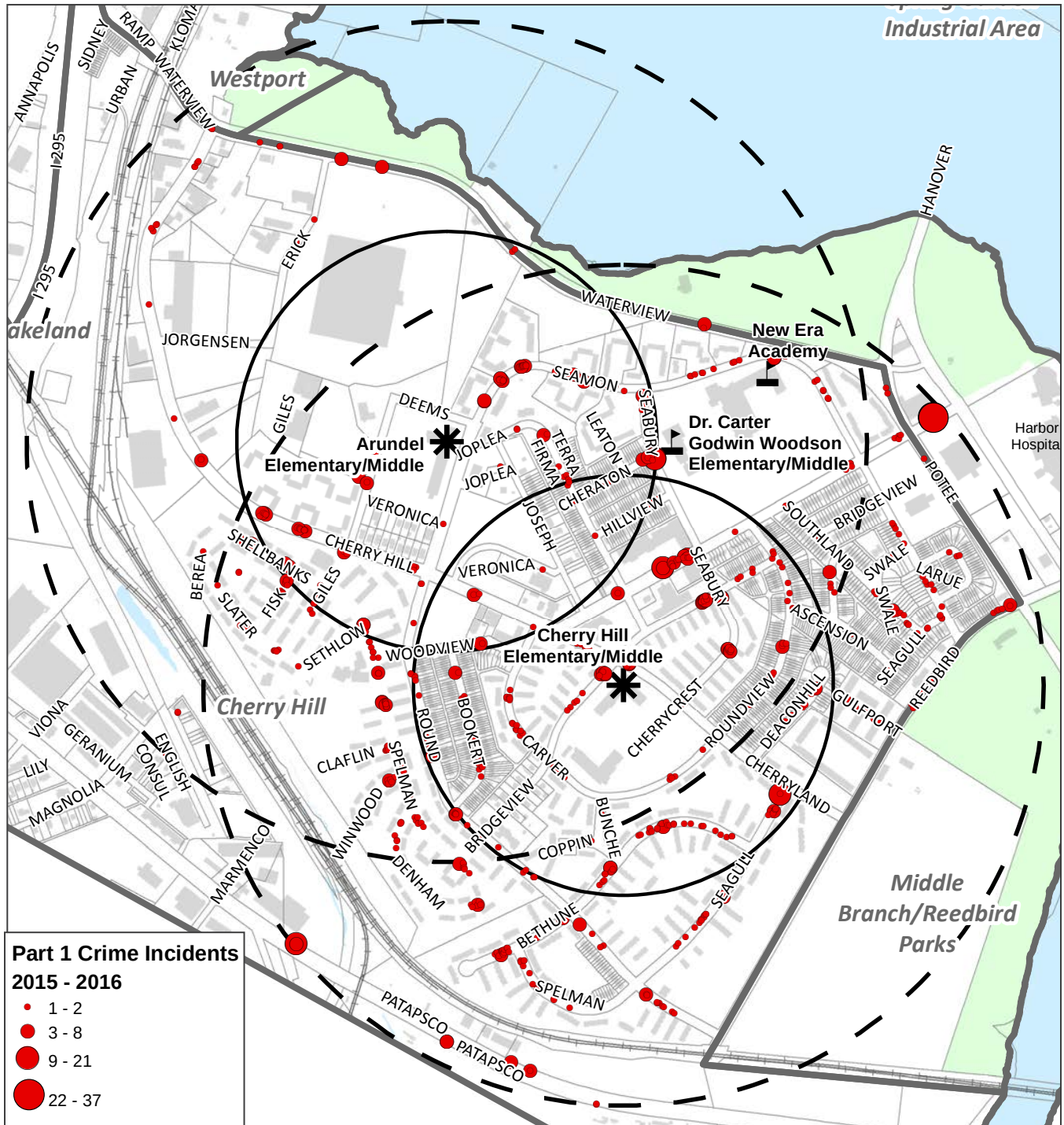
311 Calls - Dirty Streets and Alleys (2015-2016)

This map shows to locations of 311 calls for dirty streets and alleys.



Part 1 Crime Incidents (2015-2016)

Part 1 crimes are incidents of homicide, rape, aggravated assault, arson, robbery, burglary, larceny, and auto theft.



Appendix B: Public Input

During 2016, planning staff worked with residents to better understand their neighborhood experiences, concerns, and needs. The following is a summary of stakeholder comments collected from community workshops, a student workshop, and surveys. At the end there is information about selection of the community project.

INSPIRE Workshops: March 22, 2016 and April 28, 2016

The Department of Planning held two INSPIRE kick-off workshops – one in the morning and one in the evening – to make it possible for more parents and residents to participate. The following **Strengths (S)**, **Weaknesses (W)**, and **Opportunities (O)** were recorded:

<i>Community Cohesion</i>	
S	There are strong family and community ties in the neighborhood
S	There are good collaborations between community organizations and the schools
S	There is a desire for improvement and growth
S	Residents feel a sense of possibilities
S	Cherry Hill is a “real community” with defined borders
S	Cherry Hill is a “city within a city”
S	Cherry Hill is the “best kept secret” in Baltimore
S	Strong and engaged faith-based community (mentor at schools, have health fairs, prayer walks, focus on healthy foods)
S	Strong community organizations
S	Residents have pride in the neighborhood and its history; successful residents
W	Lack of participation in community concerns
W	Need more effective communication about what’s happening/opportunities for people to be involved
O	Get people involved in the variety of things going on
O	Lots of great leaders from the community – install plaques to showcase leaders/success stories to inspire children
O	Create “one voice” – currently there’s no power because there’s no unity among community partners/churches/neighborhood stakeholders
<i>Transportation</i>	
S	Connection to the neighborhood is OK/there are transportation options – light rail, buses
S	Cherry Hill is a walkable, pedestrian-friendly neighborhood
W	Public transportation needs improvement – need to increase ridership; need better access between light rail and Cherry Hill
W	There is a planned reduction of bus service that will negatively impact the neighborhood
W	Streets are in poor condition
O	Need walking paths
O	Improve access to buses; reroute buses to work better
O	Improve access to the light rail stations – provide a bus or shuttle. Many people live closer to the light rail stop across from the CSX tracks, and walk across the tracks to that stop – it’s unsafe
<i>Open Space and Recreation</i>	
S	The waterfront – the view, the possibilities for recreation, education, etc.
S	There is a lot of green – in the neighborhood and in Middle Branch Park)
S	There are two swimming pools
S	There is a recreation center and there is going to be a new rec center
S	The Rowing Club is good, although underutilized
W	Playground equipment is poorly maintained
W	There are not enough places for children to play throughout the neighborhood
O	The Rec Center should teach kids how to swim
O	The Rowing Center should teach kids how to row

<i>Community Assets</i>	
S	The family health center and hospital are assets
S	Police station
S	There is a library
O	Port Covington: create a Human Resource center in Cherry Hill – leverage the incentives they’re getting from the City to benefit the neighborhood.
O	Casino money – this is relatively flexible
<i>Safety and Sanitation</i>	
S	The area around the school (Cherry Hill) is safe
S	Citizens on Patrol/Safe Streets/partnership with police
W	High speed cars + children = unsafe conditions – especially on Round Road, around the schools, and around the Town Center; Need improved crosswalks
W	Need better lighting and sidewalks for safer walks to school. Kids want to walk, but younger kids may not feel safe.
W	The methadone clinic behind Arundel Elementary – patrons cut through Arundel school blacktop to get into the woods
W	The light rail stop seems unsafe – poorly designed/under tunnel/needs security; Drug activity near the light rail
W	Crime; gang violence
W	Overgrown lots needs to be maintained, including large lots near the pool (note: these might be a part of the park)
O	Make the area around the light rail station safer
<i>Business and Employment</i>	
W	There is a lack of businesses, including a bank, clothing stores, post office, movie theater
W	Cherry Hill is a food desert – need an affordable grocery store/food market (former markets have failed)
W	There is a lack of restaurants
W	There are no local jobs
O	Employment through business development
O	Would like to see a mix of stores along Reedbird Road
O	Incubators, like City Garage, but for retail
O	Have an Advisory Board for tenant selection of local businesses
O	Job training programs and placement of residents, especially for Under Armour and MedStar
<i>Housing and Land Use</i>	
W	Need larger housing units – most are too small to accommodate the size of families living in the neighborhood
W	There is some vacancy
W	Vacant public housing units are dangerous and have trespassers
W	Some of public housing units are infested
O	Mixed-income housing – there are renters in the neighborhood who want to buy in the neighborhood, but will leave if there’s no stock
O	Upgrade the housing stock
O	Reuse of properties

<i>Health/Food Access</i>	
S	Farm stands here now; love idea of green house or farmer's market
W	Health facility is not open on weekends
W	Lack of affordable fruits and vegetables;
W	Need for a supermarket and good food access
W	Too many fast food restaurants
O	Improve accessibility of community gardens to buy vegetables (more times of the week); make cost more affordable
<i>Education/Schools</i>	
W	Unmet needs to students are concerning – social/emotional aspects including chronic absences and lack of parent involvement; help families to better participate in getting children prepared; need to help families flourish
O	Bring the families between schools together before opening day
O	Mentor programs; paid senior citizen mentors/tutors for elementary schoolsCenter; Need improved crosswalks
O	Help middle school students see alternatives/shift attitudes; Boys/girls clubs, after-school programs to keep kids busy from 3-6pm; homework time/prepare kids for tests and what they need for achievement
O	Expansion of Head Start
<i>Image/Marketing</i>	
W	Don't like "distressed" label – leads to eminent domain and less policing
O	Partner with different media to show the positive things in the community and schools
O	Community newsletter
<i>General Concerns</i>	
What's the waterfront view going to be like if Port Covington doesn't have a height restriction? Our views of downtown could be blocked.	
If families move into new housing near the waterfront concern that new families might not send their kids to neighborhood schools; in general, existing community may not be supported by new residents.	
Concerns about increase in cost of living in neighborhood.	
Consider the needs of senior citizens.	
Concern about people not qualifying for jobs because of past convictions.	

Community Survey Responses

DOP administered a survey to parents, family members, and residents through meetings and online. The survey was also distributed by Steering Committee members and through Cherry Hill Community Coalition meetings. 42 responses were received.

General	
What are the public places that you like to spend time in the neighborhood?	
Middle Branch Park/Parks	Church
Work	Playgrounds
Track	Community restaurant
Town Center	Pools
Basketball courts	Library
My front steps	My neighbors' houses
If I could add one thing to my neighborhood it would be...	
Recreation/Recreation Programming (44%)	
Parks	More places for the kids to go after school
More playgrounds and recreation so the children can have something to do	Basketball court and an operating recreation center for kids
More after school activities in the community for children	More programs for the children
Businesses/Services (30%)	
Quality supermarket/grocery store	A bank because you need a solid business in your community to help establish community
More black-owned businesses	Market, so it's easy to get food
Parent Resources/Classes (11%)	
More classes for parents to become better parents	Help the parents to better themselves, so they can reach out to the kids more
Community (7%)	
More family-friendly events	Involve community more in the schools
Police/Security (7%)	
More police	More security
If I could take away one thing from my neighborhood it would be...	
Drugs/Violence/Crime (77%)	
Drugs and drug addicts	Shootings
Gangs	
Negative Behavior (15%)	
Kids bullying	Most of the people that are not working because they are the ones causing the problems
Non-local Business (8%)	
Other people in the community establishing businesses	

Quality of Life	
What do you like most about your neighborhood?	
<i>It's a community of neighbors/it's home</i>	
I was born here and it's my community	History, family, lineage, potential greatness
Everyone knows everyone	The neighbors
The people are friendly most of the time	My kids. Grandmother lives down the street
Children, Kids, A lot of kids, The kids	I've always lived here, so I'm used to the environment
People are friendly; there are people who have been here for 40-50 years that are like you wise, supportive, caring, concerned grandparents; there are people who are new to the community who don't try to be neighbors with anyone	
<i>It's peaceful</i>	
Serenity; proximity to waterfront	It's quiet; it's clean and well-maintained; close to several areas (if you have a vehicle)
Quiet sometimes	It's not in the city
<i>The location/accessibility</i>	
I like that everything is in walking distance	It's near the schools
School is close to home	Location, close to Inner Harbor and downtown
Convenience	
<i>The school</i>	
I like the school my daughter attends	The school and some things they do for the kids
My child's school offering programs for parents	
<i>12% of respondents said that they did not like anything in their neighborhood.</i>	
We asked if residents were aware of resources in their neighborhood and if they used them. Almost everyone who responded felt that these resources were safe and in good repair.	
<i>Does the neighborhood have...</i>	<i>Do you use it?</i>
Swimming Facility: 12 said yes	4 said yes
Walking Paths: 12 said yes	4 said yes
Gym: 4 said yes	1 said yes
Bike Paths/routes: 10 said yes	3 said yes
Rec Center: 12 said yes	4 said yes
Playground: 14 said yes	6 said yes
55% of respondents rated the neighborhood as a "fair" place to raise children. 12% rated the neighborhood as "poor" or "very poor" and 8% rated it as "good" or "very good".	
Please list the major challenges that you face in raising your children in the neighborhood.	
No resources – large library with computers and better or open more days	No rec center
Not enough neighborhood/community activities for kids; need for speed bumps to slow traffic; not enough businesses	No supermarket; no safe place to play, no access to shows/plays

Lack of education; poor self-worth; violence among young adults and school kids	People are defensive and don't believe in the phrase "it takes a village to raise a child"
No grocery store; inadequate schools for today's youth	Parents not getting involved more with kids
Influences (role models)	Peer pressure; drunk adults/drugged-up; disobedient children
Poverty	Older people and the kids – the way they are being brought up to fight, always picking on other kids, no respect for adults – it's a mess
Shooting, robbing, fighting	Violence
The adults – they allow their children to be rude and disrespectful	Parenting the children with lack of resources; gang activity
Drug dealers and junkies	Adjusting to dealing with children whom parents need better parenting skills
Keeping my wife and children safe from violence and drugs; put a premium on education	Education; police harassment
Killings in the neighborhood; streets need to be fixed	Disruptive, disrespectful children and parents
Peer pressure	Loose dogs
Robbery; car break-ins	Drugs; crime
From what type of establishment in your neighborhood do you purchase healthy and affordable food?	
Farmers Market: 20%	Grocery store: 27%
Corner store: 20%	Convenience store: 13%
There is no place: 67%	
43% of the respondents stated that they are involved in non-school programs at the school, or that they use the school resources in some way.	
Any other comments about your experience living in the neighborhood you'd like to share?	
It's beautiful to see my neighborhood	I would not want to live anywhere else
There's only one Cherry Hill community in the entire world like us	Good housing
I want my community to unify and raise our children as a whole, not every man for himself	Lack of sharing positive information
Have more crossing guards so kids are safe going to school	We need a market
Not enough buses coming through Cherry Hill	

<i>Safety</i>	
78% reported feeling safe (68%) or very safe (10%) traveling in the neighborhood.	
Those who reported feeling unsafe (10%) or very unsafe (13%) said they felt the most unsafe for the following reasons and in the following locations:	
The whole district/all of the area (multiple responses)	Walking takes a long time and criminals have time/opportunity to take action
The shopping center	Neighborhood young people do not honor anything or anyone; adults with children are not teaching their children to enjoy life, share concerns instead of trying to destroy one another
The bottom of Bunch Road	Someone may try to steal a bike
The street right by the school since two people got shot there	
These were suggestions that would make them feel safer in the neighborhood:	
More activities to include young people into a productive way of life (boys clubs, playgrounds, art club, recreation centers)	More crossing guards to lead children across the street – they run and don't look
Recreation center	Lighting
More security on routes home to mediate nonsense carried from school	School officers around the school until all the scholars are inside the building
Speed humps on the street due to fast cars	A change in the environment as a whole
More police and security – on patrol, in high crime areas, walking through neighborhoods (multiple responses)	Less police harassment
Community and police involvement	
<i>Transportation</i>	
60% of the respondents' households own a vehicle.	
Individuals who responded to the survey got around by the following (responses are not exclusive):	
Driving alone: 50%	Public transportation: 38%
Walking: 33%	Carpooling: 12%
Taking a taxi: 2%	Biking: 5%
57% responded that their child got to school by walking. Other means are as follows. Answers were not mutually exclusive.	
Driven: 33%	Public transportation: 12%
Carpooled: 2%	No response: 17%
Of children who walked or biked, they did so:	
With an adult: 88%	With other children: 18%
By themselves: 12%	
64% of the respondents felt like nothing made it difficult for them or their child to walk and/or bike throughout the neighborhood. Of the 26% that did feel like there were difficulties, these were mentioned:	
Personal physical condition/difficulties	Poor public transportation
Construction work/utilities workers	Children's after-school behavior; no mutual respect
Violence	Hills
Weather	Stray Cats

Community Project Survey

From the list of recommended projects, seven were selected for consideration for a special project funded through INSPIRE. Posters and flyers were shared throughout the neighborhood, inviting residents to text or e-mail their preference. As the results below show, the top priority was to improve the pedestrian walkway along Seabury between Cherry Hill Road and Bridgeview Avenue to provide a safe route for students north of Cherry Hill Road to walk to Cherry Hill Elementary/Middle School. The students from Arundel who voted in their classrooms endorsed upgrading playgrounds, followed by the same priority for improving Seabury.

- Covered or artistic bus shelters: 15%
- Signage, shed, or market stand for the community garden: 7%
- Upgrade playground equipment: 19%
- Benches at the Town Center: 3%
- Plaques or signs for community history/leaders: 17%
- New neighborhood signs: 6%

What project would you like to see INSPIRE fund in Cherry Hill?

***Send a text to: 22333**

1. In the message field, type and send: inspirech
2. Next, in the message field, type and send the letter that matches your selection (A, B, C, D, E, F, or G)
3. Text "Leave" to exit poll

To: 22333

Message

inspirech

Vote 1/9 - 1/20, 2017

A. Covered or artistic bus shelters			D. Benches at the Town Center		
B. Signage, shed, or market stand for community garden	Current sign		E. Plaques or signs for community history/leaders		
C. Upgrade playground equipment/ play areas			F. New neighborhood signs		Current sign
G. Landscaping the vacant lot/ footpath near Health Center		Current site			

* Standard text messaging rates apply. Each phone number can only vote once.

Can't text? Contact Brent Flickinger to vote: (410) 396-5936 or Brenton.Flickinger@baltimorecity.gov

The photos of examples are shown as ideas—actual design would be developed with residents and other stakeholders.

Appendix C: Programs & Initiatives

Appendix C contains information about, and links to, programs and initiatives mentioned in this plan.

The **Baltimarket Healthy Corner Store Program** works with store owners and with communities to make healthy food available in corner stores. The Healthy Corner Store Program is a part of Baltimarket, a suite of community-based food access and food justice programs through the Baltimore City Health Department (BCHD).

<http://www.baltimarket.org/healthy-corner-stores/>

The **Baltimarket Virtual Supermarket Program** allows Baltimore residents to order groceries online and pick them up at set locations with no registration or delivery fees. Providing access to healthy foods at supermarket prices, especially in neighborhoods where food access is limited, is the goal. The Virtual Supermarket Program is run by the Baltimore City Health Department's Baltimarket program in partnership with ShopRite.

<https://www.baltimarket.org/virtual-supermarket/>

The **Baltimore Energy Challenge** teaches low to no cost ways to save energy to Baltimore City residents, businesses, and nonprofits through a grassroots effort in neighborhoods and schools. The website provides information about the Community Engagement Program, Energy Efficiency Program, the Baltimore Business Energy Challenge, and more.

<https://baltimoreenergychallenge.org/about>

Baltimore Food Policy Initiative (BFPI) is an intergovernmental collaboration between the Department of Planning, Office of Sustainability, Baltimore City Health Department, and Baltimore Development Corporation. It was founded in 2010 to "improve health outcomes by increasing access to healthy affordable food in Baltimore City's food deserts". With each agency lending its expertise, the City creates comprehensive strategies that tackle food access from many perspectives, and implements programs and policies with multi-sector support. Interested parties can contact BFPI through the Planning Department to learn more about food-related issues in Baltimore.

<http://www.baltimoresustainability.org/projects/baltimore-food-policy-initiative/>

The **Baltimore Housing website** provides information about many programs and incentives, including homebuyer incentives, weatherization and energy efficiency programs, and more.

<http://www.baltimorehousing.org/>

Blue Water Baltimore is a not-for-profit organization with a mission to restore the quality of Baltimore's rivers, streams and harbor to foster a healthy environment, a strong economy, and thriving communities. Blue Water Baltimore is working to make our streams, river and Harbor healthy, thriving ecosystems that are accessible and safe for citizens, visitors and commerce. To achieve these goals, Blue Water Baltimore mobilizes volunteers to monitor the Baltimore area streams for pollution. They organize trash cleanups, plant trees on public land, and provide a helping hand to property owners who want to do their part to reduce runoff from their properties. Blue Water Baltimore advocates for stronger laws for clean water, both locally and statewide.

<http://www.bluewaterbaltimore.org/>

Casino Local Impact Grants (LIG) funds, provided either by the City with advice of the Local Development Council (LDC) or the Community Impact District (South Baltimore Gateway Partnership—SBGP), provide for a range of capital projects and human services, from tree planting to programs to address attendance in the schools. Cherry Hill is one the neighborhoods eligible for LIGs. The web site will be launched in spring 2017.

The **Disaster Preparedness and Planning Project (DP3)** develops a unified approach to hazard mitigation and climate adaptation. It was created to address existing hazards while simultaneously preparing for hazards predicted by climate change. The Public Safety Committee can also work with the Office of Sustainability to include neighborhood-specific recommendations in the DP3 update.

<http://www.baltimoresustainability.org/plans/disaster-preparedness-plan/>

The **Family League Summer Food Service Program** serves breakfast, lunch and supper to eligible sites around the City. In the summer, Family League goes to community sites around the city and uses mobile food vans to serve food to children so that they get the food and nutrition they need to grow, learn and thrive.

<http://familyleague.org/focus/food-access/summer-meals-program/>

KaBOOM! is a national non-profit dedicated to giving all kids the childhood they deserve, filled with balanced and active play, so they can thrive. KaBOOM! works to bring balanced and active play into the daily lives of all children, particularly those growing up in poverty in America.

<https://kaboom.org/>

The **Maryland Green Schools Award** is a program of the Maryland Association of Environmental and Outdoor Education that allows schools and their communities to evaluate their efforts in environmental sustainability. Participating schools empower youth to make changes to reduce environmental impact, encourage sustainability and foster environmental literacy.

<http://maeoe.org/green-schools/>

The **Mayor's Office of Employment Development (MOED)** coordinates and directs workforce development initiatives responsive to the needs of Baltimore City employers and job seekers in order to enhance and promote the local economy.

<http://moed.baltimorecity.gov/>

The **National Resource Network** launched as part of the Obama Administration's Strong Cities, Strong Communities initiative, and develops and delivers innovative solutions to American cities to help them address their toughest economic challenges. NRN works with local leaders to identify practical solutions, share real-world expertise and best practices, and help cities develop the tools and strategies they need to grow their economies.

www.nationalresourcenetwork.org/en/home

The **Office of Sustainability – Green, Healthy, Smart Challenge Grant** is a grant program for student-led sustainability projects in Baltimore City Public Schools. Students must be a part of an organized green team that meets to complete their project. The aim is to have projects encourage and assist schools in reaching Maryland Green School Certification.

<http://www.baltimoresustainability.org/projects/green-schools-initiative/green-healthy-smart-challenge/>

TreeBaltimore serves as the umbrella organization for all City agencies, private organizations, and individuals in their effort to increase the tree canopy of Baltimore. TreeBaltimore partners with individual homeowners, communities, schools, and businesses to establish, manage, and preserve trees. This mayoral initiative, led by Baltimore City Recreation and Parks, partners with Blue Water Baltimore, the Parks & People Foundation, Baltimore Tree Trust, and the Alliance for the Chesapeake Bay.

<http://treebaltimore.org/>

The **Safe Routes to School** program in Baltimore City aims to substantially improve safety for students in grades K-8 who walk and bike to school. The three main goals of the program are: to enable and encourage children, including those with disabilities, to walk and bike to school; to make biking and walking to school a safer and more appealing transportation choice, thereby encouraging a healthy and active lifestyle from an early age; and to aid the planning and building of projects and activities that will improve safety and reduce traffic, fuel consumption, and air pollution nearby primary and middle schools.

The **School-Centered Neighborhood Investment Initiative** is a strategic effort to leverage the 21stCentury Buildings program through the alignment of resources, partners, and programs that can support transformational neighborhood revitalization. Sponsored by ABAG's Neighborhood and Community Development Funders Affinity Group, phase one of the initiative will concentrate on the Cherry Hill, Park Heights, Southwest Baltimore, and Reservoir Hill neighborhoods to attract private investment, increase the capacity of community based organizations and leverage physical development within communities and improve the lives of families in target areas. Phase two neighborhoods include Southeast Baltimore, Govans and Coldstream/Homestead/Montebello.

<http://www.abagrantmakers.org/?page=SCNI&hhSearchTerms=%22scni%22>

A **walking school bus** is a group of children walking to school with one or more adults. That may sound simple, and that is part of the appeal. It can be as informal as two families taking turns walking their children to school or as structured as a planned route with meeting points, a timetable and a schedule of trained volunteers. A variation on the walking school bus is a bicycle train where a group of children and adult leaders ride together to school.

http://guide.saferoutesinfo.org/walking_school_bus/